

DARK PSYCHOLOGY

SECRETS

USE COVERT PERSUASION AND THE ART OF READING PEOPLE TO
INFLUENCE ANYONE THROUGH UNDETECTED MIND CONTROL, NLP AND BRAINWASHING.
STOP BEING MANIPULATED AND LEARN TO FORESEE HUMAN BEHAVIOR



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Dark Psychology Secrets

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Introduction

Have you ever wondered about what it might be like to control someone else's behavior? Do you believe it is possible? Have you ever admired the behavior of a serial killer on your favorite true crime program and wondered what it would be like to feel so fearless? If so, we are inviting you to climb into the world of dark psychology and to take a look around—with a flashlight, of course.

This book is going to explore the various dark individuals that dominate the study of dark personalities, as well as the various skills and techniques they employ to wreak havoc on the rest of the population. We will dive deep into the origins of these techniques, how they are utilized by these malevolent personalities, and how you can learn to take advantage of these skills in your own more benevolently.

We will work to demystify the notion of mind control and break it down in psychological concepts. We will show you that it is indeed possible but not in the way that the movies and novels depict it to you. Conceptualizations of manipulation, coercion, influence, brainwashing, subliminal messaging, and hypnosis will be discussed in a simple language. Descriptions from individuals who have been victims of this intense form of mind control will share their experiences. We will warn you about ways that you—yes, you—and many other people on the planet can be more susceptible to these covert tricks. A specific form of manipulation that falls under the category of abuse will be detailed and explained about how to escape a dark

personality's grips. Finally, we will offer a practice section that shows you specific methods of applying these techniques to those around you, including yourself.

This book will also offer historical examples of how dark psychological traits have manifested in real individuals outside your television screen. Hitler, Stalin, Rasputin, and even Paul Bernardo will be assessed for their position within the Dark Triad so you will get a firmer grip on what it means to possess one of these intriguing personalities. Stereotypes about psychopathy will be sliced in half and described in detail so you can gain a better understanding of what the word means. Get to know yourself better through the exploration of other people's personalities and learn that it takes more than violence to fall into the Dark Triad category.

Take a journey to the dark side and explore its wonders and horrors. Learn about the power of the mind and that no magic is required to get that big promotion you have always wanted. Come with us and find a silver lining within every dark cloud of personalities that roam this world. Use the power of your mind to learn how to focus harder, to manifest your hopes into reality, to hypnotize someone, to brainwash customers into giving you bigger tips, and to realize that every tool you need to do these things is already within your possession.

Chapter 1: What is Dark Psychology?

The universe has always worked in extreme dichotomies, conceptually, figuratively, and literally. There is good and bad, and light and dark. In the past, almost every story written or verbally told contained a distinguishable protagonist and antagonist, balancing out the tale with both horrific and wonderful scenarios that enhanced one another's effect through their contrasting natures. The superhero genre, for example, easily utilizes this storytelling tactic: Spiderman vs. The Green Goblin and Batman vs. The Joker. We know as observers that the morality of the 'good guy' acts in the direct offense to the 'bad guy', leading to an ongoing struggle of behavior and values. It is only more recently that storytelling in film and novels have begun to recognize something that personality psychology has long been aware of, which is that most individuals are divisions of a variety of traits, rather than an extreme display of one or the other. The usual good guys of the film have started having more malevolent impulses, while a flash of kindness has been expressed in the acts of a previously boxed-in villain.

You may have at some point recognized this about yourself that you are more than just simply being good or bad. You may have felt an impulse to take the last cookie from the jar when your mother specifically told you not to or you may be a person who does not do well in school or your job but feel the desire to open the door for older or disabled people. The amount of goodness and badness existing in everyone varies greatly on several blending factors that the entire scope of psychology has studied over decades.

This is what this book is going to express to you: the simple fact that not every individual is either good or bad, living in the light or thriving in the dark. Many people may have believed in the past that they were entirely bad but are working towards a more positive future. A person who may have acted with positive intentions for the majority of their lives may feel desires that don't fit within their general interpretation of themselves. Most people are a medley of traits, affected by genetics and nature of their upbringing.

If you are reading this book, don't think that you are a bad person for doing so; some skills and qualities were once attributed to individuals of ill will that a person with good intentions can take advantage of. This informational and practical guidebook is not here to judge you or the skills in which you decide to blend into your daily life.

This book will dive into the deep history of what is called dark psychology, what the phrasing connotes coercion, the traits, and behavior of those with extremely diagnosable dark psychological traits. You will be informed about what kind of tactics these individuals utilize toward their victims and how you can avoid becoming one of their victims by noticing how they use manipulation, coercion, and even methods of mind control to get what they want. You will even notice how people in your life have been using these tactics to manipulate you, whether it be within a romantic relationship or from a parenting perspective. You might even detect some of the tendencies in yourself, whether it be applied at work, at home, or to total strangers.

Despite the increase in research that relates to positive psychology, which is the study of people who are more productive and content with their lives,

there still exists an intrigue toward the behavior, thought patterns, and motivations of those whose intentions are primarily malevolent. Become aware of these techniques that are used on you by salespeople, politicians, partners, friends, and even family. Maybe next time, you can find a way to turn it around on them.



Chapter 2: What Being “Dark” Really Means

History is simply wrought with examples of the dark side of human nature expressing itself. Dark psychology is a construct that has existed since the beginning of time, recorded in various cultures, societies, and religions as facts of the human condition. It exists in contrast to positive psychology, which was previously mentioned, concerning thoughts, perceptions, and feelings that drive the more malevolent actions of human beings. Dark psychology assumes that every person has this potential within their human nature, the potential and likelihood of acting out on their darker thoughts sitting upon a continuum. Like all studies of personality, it acknowledges the differences in the influence of internal and external factors that could lead to a person acting negatively against another human being. In summary, though, it is safe to say that dark psychology is the study of human behavior, thoughts, and feelings that seek to harm and use others for our benefit. These people fall under an extreme category and are selfish usually by the influence of nature and their nurture.

The Dark Triad

These dark tendencies have been organized in dark psychology about three main personality disorders that display malevolent intentions and behaviors. Research on this concept is mainly done within the world of applied psychology, where psychological methods and findings are used to solve practical problems of human and animal behavior. This is done to assess personality types and traits that are more likely to commit crimes, cause distress, or cause enough harm to disrupt a workplace situation. Research on the dark triad was initialized in 1998 when McHoskey, Worzel and

Szyarto, three psychologists studying the personality and social psychology, claimed that narcissism, Machiavellians, and psychopathy were interchangeable concepts in an academic journal. Another personality psychology researcher, Delroy L. Paulhus, debated this with McHoskey at an American Psychological Association conference. This debate then inspired a body of work that claimed the three varied enough in behavioral, personality, and cognitive elements that they should be categorized differently.

While it was agreed that some of the traits overlap in definition, there was enough difference to keep them separate as their distinct personality trait.

In this section, we will be referring to what is called in the study of personality the Big Five Personality Model and how it relates to the dark triad, also known as the Five-Factor Model (FFM) and the OCEAN model, a summary five different traits of a personality that are believed to encompass every person. The degree of the five factors all add up together to create a single personality. These dimensions are broad and act as more of a suggestion than a neurological fact.

The five factors that we will refer to are as follows:

1. **Openness to Experience:** A person described as either inventive/curious or consistent/cautious.
2. **Conscientiousness:** A person described as either efficient/organized or easy-going/careless.
3. **Extraversion:** A person described as outgoing/energetic or solitary/reserved.

4. **Agreeableness:** A person described as friendly and compassionate or challenging/detached.
5. **Neuroticism:** A person described as sensitive/nervous or secure/confident.

For each personality type in our triad, there is a different mix of the Big Five traits, either scoring low or high, added up to form the degree in which that personality type exists in a person.

Machiavellianism

This personality trait is based upon the political theory posed by Niccolò Machiavelli. This theory claimed in 1469 that any means can be used to maintain political power. The personality trait, however, was coined by Richard Christie in the 1960s, characterized by being unemotional and lacking any concern with common morality, as well as an inclination toward deception and manipulation of others. Christie, along with fellow psychologist, Florence L. Geis, conducted a study that used Niccolò Machiavelli's statements and asked participants to rate how much they relate to ones that act as a more manipulative statement. The personality test, titled Mach-IV Test, was a twenty-statement survey that became the standard self-abasement tool for Machiavellianism. If a person scored high on this, they would be termed a "High Mach", whereas a lower scorer

would be labeled a “Low Mach”. While using this scale, Christie and Geis conducted more experiments that assessed the difference between the two personality types. Their results have been highly referenced in personality research. A summary of these results stated that males score on average slightly higher than females. Behavioral genetics, of course, play a role as environmental influences do.

Skills, abilities, and motivations: Machiavellian motivation is often termed in the psychological literature as a cold instrumental personality. Those who score high on this trait tend to pursue their motives selfishly in ways that often seek to deceive others. Other research has stated that those who score high on Machiavellianism place a high priority on power, competition, and money, with self-love and family commitment existing as a low priority if a priority at all. The key to identifying someone with this personality trait is to recognize that they will do anything to achieve their goals, no matter the harm caused to others.

Machiavellianism is associated with low emotional intelligence, which is an inability to utilize empathy and comprehend the emotional expression of others.

It was once believed that those High Mach’s possessed a high IQ because of their distinct ability to manipulate others and to anticipate the thoughts and reactions of those of whom they are using for their sole benefit. But studies have found that this is not the case of possessing unique cognitive abilities, and due to the emotional deficit, they are simply more willing to engage in manipulation than the average person.

With the Big Five personality traits, Machiavellianism negatively correlates with Agreeableness and Conscientiousness. This means that a person with these traits will more than likely be described as careless and detached from others.

Example of Machiavellianism: Besides the standard examples of individuals that are friends and family, there seems a pervasive presence of Machiavellianism in the workplace. It has been studied extensively over the past few decades due to its consistently present nature. An example of this could be a coworker or even your boss manipulating you or others to get higher in the company coldly. The person may be aggressive and even exploit others to get exactly what it is that they want.

Narcissism

This personality type name was taken from Greek mythology, the story of Narcissus, a young man who fell in love with his own image. It became a psychological concept during the time of Freud and psychoanalysis in 1914 when Freud wrote *On Narcissism*. Narcissistic personality disorder replaced the phrase megalomania in the Diagnostic Statistical Manual since 1968.

The Seven Deadly Sins of Narcissism

James F. Masterson and Hotchkiss were psychiatrists who identified features of a narcissistic personality, and they are listed as follows:

1. **Shamelessness:** People with this extreme personality type are very proud and are not limited by the needs of others. They reject any form of shame because it implies that they may need to change and are not flawless. Guilt is easier for them because then they can remove themselves from their actions. They are never wrong or bad in any way.
2. **Magical Thinking:** A narcissist cannot see anything wrong with themselves because feeling shame may destroy them. They distort their thoughts and behaviors so they can never be seen as behaving wrong, thinking wrong, or generally, being wrong.
3. **Arrogance:** A narcissist applies shame and degrading onto others so they can refill their sense of self-importance, should it be lingering or diminishing as of late.
4. **Envy:** Instead of admitting jealousy over the success of another person or celebrating it, the narcissist maintains a sense of superiority, so their delicate self-esteem is not injured.
5. **Entitlement:** Because they feel that they deserve special treatment over others and expect complete compliance with this forced request, they experience a narcissistic injury if they are not obeyed, which could trigger narcissistic rage. Narcissistic rage is a concept that summarizes the unreasonable reaction of a narcissist when someone does or says something that is a perceived threat to their self-esteem and self-worth. It is believed that this is expressed when the narcissist feels that their true self has been revealed. This rage

can range from yelling outbursts to severe violence. (Narcissistic abuse will be discussed in a later chapter.)

6. **Exploitation:** This can happen in many ways but never is done with any consideration for the feelings or results felt by others surrounding them.
7. **Usually,** the person is in a lower position where they could not fight against this exploitation. This behavior often places narcissists within short-lived relationships.
8. **Bad Boundaries:** A narcissist does not recognize boundaries to a slight degree. They do not realize that others are separate from them and are not extensions of themselves. They simply see others as a means to meet their needs. Providing narcissistic supply to a narcissist, which is when a person is close to a narcissist, provides excessive attention or admiration to feed their pathological need to approve. Narcissists generally gravitate toward people with a codependent personality, which is when an individual defines their ability to care-take for another as their sole purpose in life. (This will also be discussed in the section about narcissistic abuse further.)

The Big Five Personality Model notes a positive correlation with extraversion, openness, and negatively with agreeableness. This would make sense because a narcissist tends to seek approval from external sources and often shares information about themselves grandiosely.

Examples of Narcissism: Many people who have grown up and recognized that they had been emotionally abused by a parent or parents were able to recognize that they were more than likely dealing with a narcissist. This falls into the same category as those who are emotionally abused in

romantic relationships, where the abuser is more often than not a narcissist, especially if the abuse has lasted for years. Identifying a narcissistic personality in the workplace or friendships relies heavily on the notion of detecting whether or not the person is ignoring your boundaries, projecting their insecurities and shame onto you, or uses degradation consistently to make themselves feel better about their true self. Detecting this form of abusive behavior will be discussed in more detail later in this book.

Psychopathy

Of the triad, this personality type is thought to be the most sinister yet the most interesting. Like narcissism, it can be diagnosed in a clinical format as a personality disorder, with some of the most nuanced and misunderstood qualities in the entire world of psychology. Various concepts intermingle and blend in the description and behavioral elements, such as the belief that sociopath and anti-social personality disorder are the same with psychopathy. For now, it is safe to say that there are some overlapping facts, but there are also many contradictory notions that we will leave to the experts to continue to explore. Take note now, that psychopathy is not the same as psychosis; the term “going psychotic” is often seen as synonymous with psychopathic behavior. The term 'psychotic' a symptom of many disorders and refers to the experience of hallucinations and delusions by those with diagnoses of schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, and many other substance-use disorders.

An American psychiatrist, Hervey M. Cleckley, influenced the initial criteria for diagnosing an anti-social personality in one of the first

Diagnostic Statistical Manuals (DSM). Over the years, various changes happened within the context of distinguishing anti-social personality disorder, sociopathy, and psychopathy, leading to the creation of a Psychopathic Checklist by a Canadian researcher, Robert D. Hare. Hare had corresponded with Cleckley beginning in 1980, discussing differences in their ideas for a checklist. This checklist has been renowned in the criminal justice system as well as psychological circles for the accuracy in the assessment. A final draft was related in 2003, having initially been published for public use in 1991.

Of the many conceptualizations of psychopathy, the first was Cleckley's, who categorized two kinds of the disorder into Cleckleyan Psychopathy, which displayed bold, disinhibited behavior, and criminal psychopathy that was supposedly more aggressive and disinhibited in behavior. Much later, of course, the Psychopathy Checklist was a go-to.

The Psychopathic Personality Inventory relied on its predecessors for inspiration as yet another scale measuring psychopathy, developed by Scott Lilienfeld and Brian Andrews in the late 90s. This is a self-reported scale, rather than an interview, and is usually conducted on non-criminal subjects.



To narrow down the various components that create this complex expression of personality, the triad model was created. It takes into account the various questions and primary assessments made within the Psychopathic Checklist and the Psychopathic Personality Inventory. These are the three most observable traits of a psychopath:

1. **Boldness:** The person rarely experiences fear, tolerates minimal stress, uncertainty and danger, and has high self-confidence and assertiveness.
2. **Disinhibition:** Poor impulse control makes it difficult to plan or foresee results of behavior. The person lacks effect and the ability to control their urges. They want instant gratification and cannot restrain themselves.

3. **Meanness:** Like Machiavellianism and narcissism, psychopaths possess a very low level of empathy and attachment to others. They are intentional cruel to gain power, use exploitive techniques, and engage in destructive excitement seeking.

The psychopath would score low on consciousness, neuroticism, and agreeableness.

Examples of psychopathy: There are many examples of psychopathy in the pop culture and criminal justice system that transcend a standard textbook approach. Beyond violent characters and criminals, psychopaths can exist without having murdered someone or even physically assaulted them. Many psychopaths thrive in powerful positions, as politicians, CEOs, or even kind, charming neighbors. Psychopaths can use their charm to fool you into believing that they are one way, whereas, they are completely willing to use their sense of confidence and lack of empathy to exploit you for their means. There is an endless list of psychopaths that you could probably google right now, so we will let you do that in your own time. But try to remember that not all psychopaths are alike, just like not all people with the same mental health disorder are the same in how their disorder is expressed. Many people who abused loved ones can be seen as psychopaths, whether it be physically or psychologically. Take caution when labeling psychopathy in your life as it stretches beyond expressions of violence and it easily interpreted the manipulation.

A Fourth Trait

Beyond the initially created triad, there exists a fourth personality type or trait that many modern psychologists feel belongs to the dark collection of description. That one is Sadism, which is defined similarly as the first three in the range of callous behavior, but less on the scale of impulsiveness and willingness to manipulate others. What sadists thrive upon is the enjoyment of cruelty to others. The word comes from Marquis de Sade, a 16th-century French philosopher and writer—his works covered philosophy with sexual fantasies and violent actions. Because of their craving for cruelty, most sadists gravitate toward professions that allow them to inflict physical or mental harm on others and have it not been questioned.

Some psychologists disagree on the categorization of sadism within a collective because it is highly correlated with anti-social behavior and can predict the diagnosis of antisocial personality disorder. Nevertheless, it is still a personality trait to consider when trying to comprehend the darker side of the human condition.

Examples of a sadist: A sadist could be a person in authority, such as a police officer or soldier or any person who enjoys causing harm to others emotionally, physically, or psychologically. A sadist could also be a person who abuses others who exists outside the categorization of a narcissist.

Other Possible Dark Psychological Personalities/Traits

The following do not fit within the previously mentioned and agreed upon triad or tread of dark psychological personalities and traits but have been proposed in other areas of personality psychology.

Vulnerable Dark Triad

The VDT contains three related and very similar constructs of personality: vulnerable narcissist, factor 2 psychopathy, and borderline personality disorder. A study was conducted and found that these three constructs are very similar and manifest themselves in a personality in ways that may be indistinguishable:

1. **The Vulnerable Narcissist:** It is a kind of narcissist that is less obvious than an average one. They have the same high grandiose opinion of themselves, but often, they are quiet and easy-going. They believe that the world is out to get them and that there is nothing wrong with them. They are constantly the victim, never take responsibility for their behavior, and crave constant sympathetic attention. They want the people around them to see how truly perfect they are.



2. **Factor 2 Psychopathy:** The factor description of this form of psychopathy is from the Psychopathy Checklist that was previously mentioned, also called the Hare Psychopathy Checklist. The factors separate the two and often blending elements of what it means to be a psychopath. Factor 1 is the apparent core personality trait of a psychopath and is associated with extraversion and positive effect. These may be beneficial for the psychopath. Factor 2 is more related to negative results of their personality, such as reactive anger, criminality, and impulsive violence.
3. **Borderline Personality Disorder:** This is a severe personality disorder that is defined by the instability of self, mood, and relationships. Mental health professions describe the main nine symptoms of the disorder as follows:
 - Fear of abandonment
 - Unstable relationships
 - An unclear of shifting self-image
 - Impulsive, self-destructive behaviors
 - Self-harm
 - Extreme emotional swings
 - Chronic feelings of emptiness
 - Explosive anger
 - Feeling suspicious or out of touch with reality

These three personality types relate more to introversion and disinhibition, rather than extroversion some of the disinhibition of a narcissism, a Machiavellian, or psychopath.

Malignant Narcissism

Among the several varieties of narcissism, there exists one that is categorized as a life-long syndrome and the most severe. Malignant narcissism mixes extreme expressions of anti-social behavior, aggression, paranoia, and sadism. It is still a hypothetical concept that does not exist as a diagnosable disorder within the DSM, whereas narcissistic personality disorder is.

Both malignant narcissism and narcissistic personality disorder are linked with psychopathy because they contain very small differences in personality traits.

The difference between malignant narcissism and narcissistic personality disorder lies within the comorbidity that malignant narcissism has with other personality disorders. A person with this syndrome expresses symptoms and personality traits that are broader than that of a narcissistic personality disorder alone. Additional symptoms such as antisocial, paranoid, and sadistic exist at the same time as the narcissistic ones. Because of the inclusion of these elements, unlike those with a narcissistic personality disorder, do not feel guilt or regret about their behavior towards others and how it affects them. Antisocial traits make the person lack even more empathy than the average narcissistic personality. A sadistic personality would derive pleasure from hurting others, along with feeling zero regrets or guilt in doing so.

A Dark Continuum, A Dark Factor

The previous descriptions are examples of extreme and pervasive expressions of personality that exemplify the darkest emotions, motivations, behaviors, and thoughts that manifest within the human condition. Most people, though you are going to come across in your day-to-day living, are not going to be this extreme. Try to think of these kinds of dark traits as existing on an invisible continuum, the individuals described in the previous section falling upon the furthest most radical side of personality expression. Think of every trait that was previously described existing as its continuum, with each person having different traits ranging from nonexistent, to mild, to severe.

Modern-day psychologist and professor, Michael Nuccitelli, wrote about the [\[1\]](#)dark side of the human consciousness in 2006. Within it, he describes which he calls a dark factor—a theoretical concept of the potential for dark thoughts, actions, perceptions, and behaviors that exist inside every human being. He describes it as a set of events that a person experiences, which increases their probability of engaging in more antisocial and cruel behavior. It is not a refined or definite science as it has been known that many children who have been abused grow up to abuse others themselves, but not all of them do. That is an example of a dark factor: being abused as a child.

The number of elements involved in the equation of the Dark Factor is very large as it is the relevance of the impact of these factors on a person's subjective processing. As usual, if you want to summarize the wording in a psychological sense, it is an unbalance or sometimes a balanced presence of nature and nurture in an individual's life. Even a person's Dark Factor will be different because every person's life experiences greatly differ from one

another, as do the reactions to those life experiences. Two separate people could experience the same events externally, while one reacts with retribution and violence, and the other reacts with solemnity and patience.

Purposeful Behavior and Dark Psychology

One of the basic beliefs of psychology is that all behavior a human being participates in is purposeful, no matter how benevolent or malevolent they may be. This notion was solidified by a medical doctor and psychologist who was a contemporary of Sigmund Freud, Alfred Adler. His theory on personality extended away from the psychoanalysts before him like Freud and Carl Jung, who preached about theories of the unconscious expression of behavior. These theories helped shaped how later psychologists and researchers started approaching dark psychologists and darker personality types. His theories about dark psychology can be interpreted as follows:

1. All behavior is purposeful. This means that everything we think, feel, and do has a purpose to us, perhaps in a more selfish manner. This means that when we do kind things for others, we are doing it to somehow serve ourselves. The reward one receives is praise, respect, and acceptance by their friends, family, peers, and community. This approval may come in handy in the future should we require the aid of one of these individuals.
2. This notion is expressed in Adler's theory when it comes to those who behave in more negative ways toward others as well. He believed that people who behave in aggressive or hostile ways expressed a deep sensation of inferiority. If they feel like they are not being accepted by a social group, the motivation behind behaving kind toward others

diminishes. They are not being rewarded, so they fail to participate in this behavior.

3. Adler wrote about the concept of subjective processing that is paramount to the notion of dark psychology. It is the constant relation, effect, and interaction that cognitive, affective, and behavioral states have with one another. All three of these constant interactions create our own subjective experience; reality exists objectively, but all of our experiences will always be subjective to our form of processing. People who have dark psychological traits have a different mix of those three interactions and perceive the world as out to get them, so they behave in ways that they believe will protect them and allow them to thrive in their way.
4. Adler also posed the notion of social interest. This is the compilation of perceptions, thoughts, and feelings into benevolent behaviors. The more a person feels accepted by others in their lives, the kinder that they will behave. People with a higher social interest are less likely to fall on one end of the dark continuum. It is proposed, then, that the lower the social interest is for a person, while the higher the probability that dark personality trait will come to the surface and be expressed.

This chapter explored the various traits that those with extreme dark psychological personalities possess. These individuals have a long history of cause and effect that have put them in the position they are in, whether it be within the criminal world or thriving within an organization or relationship with power. You do not have to fall under the category of one of these extreme personalities though to utilize the many benefits that come with having such a personality. Of course, we are not encouraging you to

act malevolently against others; the world does not need any more people who are inherently cruel. What this book will do is show you now the various tactics that these people employ to get what they want, to teach them, and to use them in other more positive ways that can help you learn to thrive in your way.

You will also learn about ways to observe and avoid these tactics should people in positions of power in your life use them to get their way. Most importantly, if you are being emotionally abused by a partner, parent, or anyone else in your life, you will learn about what this person is like deep inside, as well as these tactics they use to keep you coming back for more. There is always a way to look at something negatively, and turn it around, making it work to your benefit.



Chapter 3: Historical Examples of the Dark Triad

Now that you have an understanding of what dark psychology entails, we are going to give you a few examples throughout history and how these personality types have manifested themselves. The examples listed will display just how fruitful many of these traits have been for certain individuals but also the kind of dedication to that personality type required to achieve their mischievous goals.

Since there is a general agreement within the psychology community that there existed a Dark Triad, this section is going to base its examples off of the three most understood personality types within that description: Machiavellianism, narcissism, and psychopathy. The examples listed may also possess traits that carry over into other dark psychological types, but in general, will tend to reside more so within one category over another. This section will help you understand what these personality types appear like on a grander stage, which will allow you to transfer that understanding over into more common relationships, such as the ones with coworkers, friends, even family members, and romantic partners.

Machiavellianism

Niccolò Machiavelli wrote a document that has since been blended into the canals of political history, titled “The Prince”, where he outlined the most ideal and hypothetical leader in 16th Century Florence. Since then, interpretations of the text have been muddled and confused with the priorities and goals of many cities and the country’s chosen religions. As previously mentioned, a Machiavellian is generally defined by their devious

characteristics, willing to cross a moral boundary to gain a much sought-after position. Because of this definition, many politicians and world leaders have received an acute diagnosis from those who study dark psychology as a Machiavellian. For this reason, we are going to look at two of the most famous world leaders who were known for their malevolent and devious behavior: Joseph Stalin and Adolf Hitler.

A Machiavellian is defined by their core belief that the end justifies the means. This sentence could not describe Adolf Hitler, Germany's most infamous dictator to ever exist, more keenly. Before Hitler came into power as the Fuhrer of Germany, he expressed anti-Semitic views that connected to hatred of his Father. Germany at the time was suffering economically and deeply craven for a leader who would point them in a tangible direction. Due to his built-up hatred of Jewish people and the combination of a desperate plea for answers from the people of Germany, Hitler was able to rise to power rapidly using his platform of hatred toward the Jewish community. His main goal was to rid the country and Europe of Jewish people and other minorities so a distinctly Aryan world would be reborn, thus, according to him, resolving all of the world's economic and societal problems. To do this, Hitler ordered and approved of atrocious actions, which included the assassination of over 5 million Jewish people, starting a Second World War, and justifying every action that was both violent and heinous under the guise of a unified Germany. To Hitler, his end was pure, so it did not matter what he and the Third Reich did to achieve their goal. This is the hallmark of a Machiavellian.

Although many who observe the charismatic tirades and learn more about the overall personality of Adolf Hitler in private moments have labeled him

as 'mad', the term is simply too narrow and vague to cover his entire pathology. Hitler also possessed qualities of a narcissist and a psychopath, but not enough to categorize him entirely under those traits. As a narcissist, he worried exceptionally about what other people thought of him, mainly the people of Germany. But he would not fit the entire profile of a narcissist because he did have an immense amount of anxiety, whereas, a narcissist would only have a limited amount that would be satiated by praise. Psychopaths have little to no empathy, and Hitler, from his perspective, believed he was helping the people of Germany by zeroing in on the true problem plaguing their country. A psychopath would not care for this, as they merely require having power. His willingness to slaughter millions of innocent people based on their religious background though is borderline psychopathy due to its lack of ethics and horrendous violence.

Joseph Stalin was a master manipulator who ruled the Soviet Union during the Second World War. He, like Hitler, placed importance on the concept of being feared instead of being liked. He also exemplified what was written in *The Prince*, which was the prioritization of war and military strategy, even during times of peace. He used the military as a source of both manipulation and fueling of fear, establishing laws that disallowed any behavior against the government that result in immediate death, resulting in what historians now refer to as "The Great Purge". This purge was defined as the unlawful prosecution of communists and repressing of counterrevolutionaries, which involved the execution and torture of hundreds of thousands of people between 1937 and 1938. Many believe that this was done due to Stalin's paranoia and fear of an uprising, a trait he shared with Hitler. Stalin possessed more traits of a classic psychopath, as

he made it a point to keep documents about the executions in a semi-legal manner. This was tactical, of course, as the means always justified the end for Stalin, no matter how heinous the acts.

Narcissism

Many people who are diagnosed with narcissistic personality disorder are lumped into the same category as those with psychopathy. A psychopath certainly has narcissistic traits, such as a grandiose sense of importance, the ability and willingness to manipulate and abuse others to get what they want, and a lower level of empathy. The key difference though between narcissism and psychopathy is that narcissists, deep down, do care about what others think and deeply require approval and praise to fill that void. Psychopaths do not require this as their sense of self-importance is generally impenetrable.

A wonderful example of a person who historically fits the definition of a narcissistic personality is Gregory Rasputin, the Russian holy man who gained favored of a King and his wife. His story is notorious for its mystique; the man has supposed supernatural powers—his power of seduction and multiple affairs and seeming inhuman skill of staying alive. Stories of Rasputin are legendary, and there has been an abundant amount of conflicting research that often categorized him as evil, psychopathic, even mad. The truth, of course, lies somewhere in between. The only research that can be corroborated is that he was a skilled manipulator, whose true status was fueled more so by rumor and conjecture.

It took Rasputin little time to gain the favor of the imperial family as he moved through Russia in 1905, taking on the role of a holy man who gave advice and spiritual encouragement. The empress at the time was convinced of his ability to possibly cure her son who had hemophilia. The Russian people became convinced that he was giving negative military advice and created multiple rumors about supposed affairs he was having with many important imperial women. Although this has only been somewhat confirmed, it can be assessed that if this were the case, Rasputin most certainly believed himself to be a more important figure than most mystics would consider themselves. Other narcissistic traits that he possessed were that of self-importance and self-delusion; he believed he gave good political advice and was able to give it, despite lack of experience in politics and military matters. He was manipulative enough to use the imperial family to his advantage and gain power and prestige through that manipulation. He devoted himself to his religion, and in that sense, possessed a delusional sense of power and entitlement.

Rasputin, in many ways, was neither a psychopath nor a Machiavellian. Many psychopaths manipulate, as do Machiavellians, but Rasputin's level of manipulation did not transcend past what he believed was relevant and important due to his unshakable faith. Distortions in his legacy have led many readers to believe in his evil, almost supernatural power, but these estimations hold little weight when searching for actual evidence.

Psychopathy

Psychopathy is the personality type that is most often associated with violence. Narcissists can be physical abusers, and Machiavellians such as Hitler and Stalin overlooked an incredible number of violent acts. It is because of this that many individuals are mislabeled psychopaths. But it is not only psychopaths who commit violent acts, nor are all diagnosed psychopaths capable of violence. It is an association that is automatically made and confused throughout the criminal justice system's history. Therefore, the following historical examples range between the spectrum of different psychopaths, from the excessively brutal and violent, to the emancipative and empathy-void leaders.

Levels of Psychopathy

Clinical diagnoses of psychopaths tend to vary in so many ways due to their similarity between a narcissist, and when it comes to world leaders or even company leaders, Machiavellianism. There exists a dividing definition that categorizes the more violent psychopaths versus the manipulative and less violent psychopaths. This is where we will compare primary psychopathy versus secondary psychopathy and blend with our historical examples.

A primary psychopath is a person that most of us think of when we hear the word. They are the Hannibal Lecter, Frank Underwood, and Patrick Bateman that we were dominating pop culture with their blend of charm, intrigue, and tendency toward violence for violence's sake. A primary psychopath is indifferent toward the feelings of others and generally lacks empathy for anyone outside themselves and their own needs. They don't have anxiety like the narcissist and Machiavellian. They are seen as fearless, calculating, and manipulative of other people's emotions. They are

aware of emotions and how they exist in others, but they will use this to take advantage of those around them who possess an average level of empathy.

This awareness of other people's emotions is called cognitive empathy, whereas the experience of empathy is called affective empathy.

A secondary psychopath is a person that falls further upon the category of impulsivity. An impulsive psychopath relies more heavily on emotion than the primary psychopath. This form of psychopathy is more closely related to Borderline Personality Disorder, which is marked by impulsivity and aggressiveness. The key to separating the distinguishing characteristics of primary and secondary psychopathy is the general experience of emotions and how those emotions are influenced by outside sources. The secondary psychopath is usually forced into behaving aggressively due to the feeling of emotions such as depression and anxiety, as well as the influence of lifelong trauma and the inability to categorize those emotions healthily. A primary psychopath does not feel these emotions and inherently lacks a sense of right and wrong in accordance to societal standards. Because of this lacking, they will not feel anxiety and depression and merely act of a void of these feelings.

So, who are important examples of both primary and secondary psychopaths throughout history? Primary psychopaths are particularly easier to spot amongst the violent, especially those that fall under the category of a serial killer. Paul Bernardo is a Canadian rapist and serial killer who consciously drew young girls to him to torture and eventually murder. During several interviews, Bernardo expresses a controlled understanding of what he did as being seen as 'wrong' through societal

standards but expresses no remorse for the acts themselves. His behavior both before, after, and during capture showed zero empathy towards his victims and the family of the victims. This is an example of cognitive empathy versus affective empathy—he is aware of the justice system, but to him, there was not anything particularly ‘wrong’ about his behavior.

There are many other examples of violent psychopaths that can be easily found through a Google search: Ted Bundy, The Zodiac Killer, and Paul Bernardo’s wife, Karla Holyoke.

All fall on a certain scale of psychopathy, which shows their particular level of lacking empathy, the tendency towards aggression, as well as the tendency to manipulate. If we are going to categorize any historical figure as a secondary psychopath, it would more than likely be Hitler. Hitler lacked empathy and used any means to his end, but he also had great anxiety and impulsivity that made it difficult for him to function and sleep. Although he would be more of a Machiavellian, secondary psychopathy would not be a far-off diagnosis.

It is, of course, important to mention again that not every person diagnosed with psychopathy is violent. Serial killers are always associated with the diagnosis, but not all serial killers are psychopaths, in the same sense that not all psychopaths are serial killers. Popular culture has mended the two into one, which often makes the discussion of a diagnosis of psychopathy more stigmatized to discuss, even more than depression and anxiety. Interviews and studies conducted over the past decade have shown what life is like for a non-violent, functioning psychopath.

One particular interview that is especially interesting was conducted by The Cut in 2011, titled “My Life as a Psychopath”, where journalist Katie Heaney interviews a woman (who wishes to remain nameless) who was diagnosed with psychopathy in her mid-twenties. She lives an average, 9-5, married life with a partner of 19 years, and has concluded that there is an entire misperception as to what her diagnosis implies. Her experience of the disorder happens with the differentiation between cognitive empathy and affective empathy. She can observe the emotions of others but cannot connect effectively to show or say to her partner what she feels. What she requires is a certain form of communication with her husband that lets her know how her behavior affects others and how she needs to behave to help out those around her. In this sense, psychopathy is categorized more so as a brain disorder, rather than one that is constantly associated with violence.

There is one aspect of a psychopath that remains consistent across all diagnoses: the necessity of having to put on a ‘mask’ for the world. A mask may not have a malevolent association, but it might.

It is a form of behaving a certain way that the world expects you to because of the way that the person is not always understood or accepted. So, if a person has this diagnosis, some of them may tend towards manipulation more than others, as well as willingness to commit violence more than others.



Chapter 4: Methods of Manipulation

The word 'manipulation' has many negative connotations to it. Manipulation can occur on both a small and large scale. It can occur on a subconscious level in romantic relationships when one partner wants something from the other without directly communicating about it. For example, one person may want the other person to pay for dinner, so throughout the meal, they complain about having no money, which entices the other to reach for the bill when payment time comes. On a more massive scale, manipulation can happen in politics, where a political leader says or does something to make the people believe one aspect of their policies or to hide from something that does not aid in their campaign. One way or another, you can probably recall a time in your life when you were manipulated or even used manipulation to your benefit with or without realizing it. Like the dark continuum, the use of this practice happens on a spectrum. There are crueler ways of using it, while others may seem more innocent, such as paying for a meal example. Most people can recall a time when they manipulated someone they care about in their lives, so try not to feel too guilty about it.

This section identifies the various tactics of manipulation that those with more narcissistic, psychopathic, and Machiavellian personalities apply to get what they want. It will help you become more aware of them and also educate you on ways that you can apply some of them, on a much smaller scale.

A psychological manipulation is a form of social influence that tries to change the behavior and perception of others through indirect, deceptive tactics. By this definition, psychological manipulation is inherently

negative. Social influence though does not have to be. Someone could have positive social influence over a family member or friend when they want them to stop participating in negative behaviors, such as drug or alcohol addiction.

Motivations of Manipulators

The following are a list of what motivates people to manipulate others, beyond the obvious of fulfilling material, social, and psychological desires:

1. A strong need to attain feelings of power and superiority over others.
2. The need to feel in control.
3. Seeing it as a game; a way to escape boredom.
4. For criminal or a covert agenda.
5. Unconscious manipulation: when the person cannot recognize their own emotions such as commitment phobias and rationalizations.

Manipulative Techniques According to Harriet B. Braiker and George K. Simon

The two main psychological researchers who contributed heavily to the study and understanding of manipulation are George K. Simon and Harriet B. Braiker. They each identified their list of techniques that most successful manipulators utilized to acquire exactly what they want from their victim.

Braiker:

- Positive reinforcement: This includes praise, fake charm, fake sympathy, excessive apologizing, gifts, and forced facial expressions to make the victim believe in a positive intention.
- Negative reinforcement: This involves removing someone from a negative situation as a reward. An example of this is telling a partner that they don't have to go to a social gathering that they don't want to go to if they allow the offender to abuse them. This is often used for children in abusive situations.
- Intermittent or partial reinforcement: This can create a climate of fear and doubt. This is done to confuse the victim, so they continue their behavior of enabling, without being able to predict the reaction of the manipulator.
- Punishment: This involves yelling, using the silent treatment, threatening, emotional blackmail, the guilt trip, and playing the victim.
- Traumatic one-trial learning: Using orally abusive behavior and explosive anger to establish dominance over another. This is done to condition the victim to avoid upsetting the manipulator.

Simon:

- Lying: Manipulators use a direct form of lying, which is called lying by commission. Certain personality types make it harder to identify a lie as it is done often and subtly, such as consistent lies told by a psychopathic personality.
- Lying by omission: This is a form of lying that withholds important information or a significant amount of truth from an audience or victim. This is often done in various forms of propaganda.

- Denial: The manipulator refuses to admit when anything they do may have been wrong.
- Rationalization: Various excuses are made for inappropriate behavior.
- Minimization: This is often coupled with rationalization. The person asserts that their behavior is not as bad as the victim is claiming it to be. The manipulator often uses the excuse of a joke if someone is offended by something they may have said.
- Selective attention/ inattention: The manipulator refuses to give attention to anything that takes them away from following through on their own hidden agenda.
- Diversion: The manipulator avoids answering a question, often moving onto another subject to stay away from being found out.
- Evasion: Also, a form of avoidance, but instead of changing the subject, they give answers that are not relevant to the question, steering away from the actual truth.
- Covert Intimidation: The manipulator throws the victim into defensive mode by using subtle threats against them.
- Guilt trip: This tactic helps the victim stay in a repeating state of self-doubt and a submissive position. The manipulator makes suggestions that make the more sensitive person feel bad about their behavior, calling them selfish and uncaring.
- Shaming: The use of sarcasm and name-calling to maintain that circle of fear and self-doubt. This makes the victim constantly feel unworthy, and thus, would never diverge away from the manipulator. Shaming can occur in facial expressions and small statements that deject the individual and their opinions, thoughts, and interests.
- Vilifying the victim: This often happens in abusive relationships, wherein the abuser puts the abused on the defense and then accuses

them of being the abuser when the victim is merely defending themselves or their position.

- **Playing the victim:** This connects with the previously mentioned tactic of vilifying the victim. They will be playing upon the kindness and sensitivity of others to get what they want by making themselves seem like the victim.
- **Playing the servant role:** This tactic is used by veiling a self-serving agenda by appearing obedient to an authority figure or to be of service to another.
- **Seduction:** The manipulator will use charm, flattery, and appearing overly supportive to make the victim trust them and open themselves up to be manipulated.
- **Projecting the blame:** This is a very common tactic of manipulators and is often done without conscious awareness. If the manipulator is found to be deceitful, then the manipulator will somehow distort this into making the victim believe that it was indeed their behavior who made them behave deceitfully. This is done also to make the victim feel guilty about partaking in healthy behaviors, such as confronting the person when they feel they are being used or manipulated.
- **Feigning innocence:** The manipulator tries to convince the victim that any harm that was done was unintentional or that they did not do something that they are accused of. This makes the victim question their judgment and motivation behind their accusations.
- **Feigning confusion:** This is simply playing dumb when their behavior or words are questioned. They make statements that further confuse their victims by inserting key elements included in an explanation to make room for the sprouting of doubt.

- **Brandishing anger:** The manipulator uses sudden anger and rage to shock the victim into submission. This is used to avoid confrontation and to avoid exposing the truth to the victim.
- **Bandwagon effect:** The manipulator comforts the victim into submission by claiming that other people have done something that they should too. This is seen in peer pressure situations, where someone is influenced into trying drugs or alcohol when they don't want to.

Personality Types and Manipulation

We have described in a previous chapter what dark personality types look like. It is not surprising to see the same types described in the section about manipulation; all of these extreme individuals utilize it for their own benefits.

Psychopathy: The most known personality type that utilizes manipulation. It is within Factor 1 of the Hare Psychopathy Checklist, and thus one of the first ways to identify a person as a psychopath.

When a psychopath manipulates you, it is going to be very hard to identify. Psychopaths in the workplace have been written about a lot in the most recent years, as understanding about the consider expands outside the zone of criminality and violence. Paul Babiak wrote about this phenomenon in his book *Snakes in Suits: When Psychopaths Go to Work*. While referencing Hare, Babiak goes into intense detail about the techniques of manipulation that psychopaths in a work environment engage in. The psychopath will create a scenario where they are seen in a positive light and then spread

negative disinformation about others, using their coworkers as pawns so the psychopath can reach their goal of status and power.

Antisocial Personality Disorder: This personality disorder is very similar to psychopathy, where the individual applies the previously described tactics to gain power, material items, revenge, or anything else that they may require for their own self-focused needs.

Borderline Personality Disorder: This personality disorder was once misunderstood as a syndrome that uses pathological lies and manipulation of others to get the attention and love these individuals so desire. Over years of studies though, it was realized that the manipulation those with BPD engage in is unintentional and comes from a place of intense pain and low self-worth.

Narcissistic Personality Disorder: As previously described in the first chapter, this personality disorder thrives on manipulation to gain narcissistic supply and maintain their distorted views of themselves as flawless.

Histrionic Personality Disorder: This personality disorder uses attention-seeking behaviors and emotions, which automatically includes manipulative behaviors. They are similar to those who are diagnosed with a narcissistic personality, meaning they constantly need approval from others and can be very sensitive to criticism. Due to the higher likelihood of women being diagnosed with HPD and men being diagnosed with NPD, it is believed that there exists a sexist gender bias in diagnostic processes.

Machiavellianism: This person is not driven or affected by the most common conception of morality and therefore has no problem using manipulation to get what they want.

Vulnerabilities of Victims

If there are personality types for manipulators, then there must be personality types for their victims. The following section will describe the traits of those who are most vulnerable to being manipulated by these dark personality types. If you identify any of these traits in yourself, please, do not fret; most average individuals who do not participate in malevolent behavior are going to fall under a few of these categories.

Barkier:

- People pleasers
- The excessive desire to earn the approval and acceptance of others
- Fear of any negative emotion, expressing anger, frustration, or disapproval called emetophobia
- A lack of assertiveness
- A fragmented sense of identity
- Soft personal boundaries
- Low self-reliance
- Low focus of control, meaning they have a minimal sense of belief that they are in control of the outcomes of events in their lives

Simon:

- **Naïveté:** The victim finds it too difficult to accept that some people are 'bad', meaning they are intentionally devious and ruthless. They may be in denial that they are being victimized.
- **Over-conscientiousness:** The victim is all too willing to give the manipulator the benefit of the doubt when they start blaming the victim for their inappropriate behavior.
- **Low self-confidence:** The victim cannot confront the manipulator, has excessive self-doubt, cannot assert themselves, and get onto the defensive very easily.
- **Over-intellectualization:** The victim tries too hard to comprehend the motivations of the manipulator beyond that of being devious and hurtful.
- **Emotional dependency:** The victim is submissive and has a dependent personality. The more they depend on the manipulator, the more vulnerable they are to being manipulated (the dependent personality will be described in more detail in the next chapter on narcissistic abuse).

Martin Kantor describes in his book *The Psychopathy of Everyday Life: How Antisocial Personality Disorder Affects All of Us* about the vulnerable traits of victims of abuse and manipulation:

- **Dependent:** They thrive on the need to be approved and loved and are more likely to say yes to something or someone of whom they believe is feeding them love and approval.
- **Immature:** Has less experience in life and thus easily believes lies and exaggerations told to them.

- **Impressionable:** Overly seduced by those who seem charming based on a single or few experiences.
- **Trusting:** Some honest people tend to believe that everyone else is honest or inherently positively motivated.
- **Carelessness:** Careless people do not give enough thought or consideration to decisions made involving others who may be taking advantage of them.
- **Lonely:** A lonely person is more likely to accept any form of human contact or perceived connection, no matter the cost.
- **Impulsive:** A person may make snap decisions without thinking things over when a person is trying to manipulate them.
- **Altruistic:** This person is very honest, fair, and far too empathic. A highly empathic person often draws in psychopaths because they want to understand them or feel that they can, even if the attempt greatly harms them.
- **Materialistic:** These kinds of people are easy prey for get-rich schemes because they appreciate owning items.
- **Greedy:** Psychopaths can entice the greedy into acting in an immoral way by playing on their need for material things or financial gain.
- **Masochistic:** A person who lacks self-respect can so easily and often unconsciously let psychopaths take advantage of them. They probably believe somewhere inside of them that they are deserving of the negative treatment they are receiving.

This chapter generalizes a lot of the traits of both a person who is a manipulator and a person who is the victim of manipulation. The next chapter will focus specifically on a very common form of manipulation and how it relates to emotional abuse: the narcissistic personality.



Chapter 5: Having a Manipulative Partner and How to Avoid Manipulation

What is a Narcissistic Personality?

The word ‘narcissist’ comes from a story in Greek mythology, where Narcissus fell in love with his image. The narcissistic personality is defined as a person who idealized their self-image and attributes to the point of negatively affected other people’s lives. Many people have possessed narcissistic traits when it has to do with a certain section of their lives but also possess a healthy dose of humility and self-doubt. This is not the case for a person with a narcissistic personality.

In 2004, psychiatrists Hotchkiss and James F. Masterson listed what they called the ^[2]*Seven Deadly Sins of Narcissism*:

1. **Shamelessness:** Narcissists do not express shame for any behavior or belief they may possess, as the sensation of feeling shame implies that they must have done something wrong.
2. **Magical Thinking:** A psychological defense mechanism that allows them to see themselves as flawless, and project shame onto others rather than feel it themselves.
3. **Envy:** A narcissist may employ the feeling of contempt toward another person to avoid feelings of jealousy in reaction to the result of another person’s achievements.
4. **Arrogance:** A narcissist likes to raise their self-importance by degrading others.

5. **Entitlement:** Believing that they are special and deserve special treatment and begin expressing narcissistic rage they are denied it (a reaction when a threat to their self-worth is perceived).
6. **Exploitation:** The narcissist may employ exploitation without regard for the feelings of others. This is usually done to another person who is in a position of subservience and cannot escape it, such as in a work setting or children at school.
7. **Lack of bad boundaries:** Boundaries simply do not exist for a person who is a full-blown narcissist. They are unaware that other people can exist not solely to suit their needs and that other people may have different thoughts or feelings than themselves. Narcissistic supply is a term used to describe how narcissist relies on codependents to fill their sense of self-worth.

Narcissistic Personality Disorder (NPD)

NPD is a personality disorder that expresses a long-term pattern of behavior that is self-focused, superior, exploitative of others, and severely lacks empathy for others. The difference between NPD and the previously described traits of a person with a narcissistic personality is the consistency of the traits and to what extent they impair their lives. This difference is described as pathological; when the expression of these traits consistently disrupts the lives of the narcissist is when a mental health diagnosis is given. Many people possess narcissistic personality traits and can live a successful and stress-free life, while those with NPD may perceive themselves this way, are not developing and achieving success due to the crippling fear of criticism, self-doubt, and failure that lies under their inflated sense of self-worth.

The Malignant Narcissist

This kind of narcissist is not bothered by guilt and can resemble antisocial personality disorder. APD is another personality disorder defined primarily by antisocial behavior that has no consideration for right and wrong. The malignant narcissist may take pleasure in causing pain and display forms of sadistic behavior. The key difference though between a malignant narcissist and an antisocial personality is the way the person relates to others.

Narcissists share a codependent relationship with others, and deep down, they require the approval of others to function.

A person with antisocial personality disorder could not care less about the opinion of others and do not require the engagement of other people to feel validated.

The Narcissist and Emotional/Psychological Abuse: What Truly Lies Beneath

Abuse is the behavioral act that a narcissist applies as a defense mechanism against a variety of emotions that the narcissist is constantly attempting to suppress. Despite the outward expression of self-importance, grandiosity, lacking empathy, and cruel behavior, the narcissist is acting out of deeply repressed sensations of fear. They fear rejection, their imperfections, and shortcomings, of being abandoned, unwanted, and unloved.

The following section will summarize 14 behavioral expressions of a narcissist and how it connects to being abusive. A narcissist could be an authority figure, a parent, a partner, a teacher, a coach, or a caregiver.

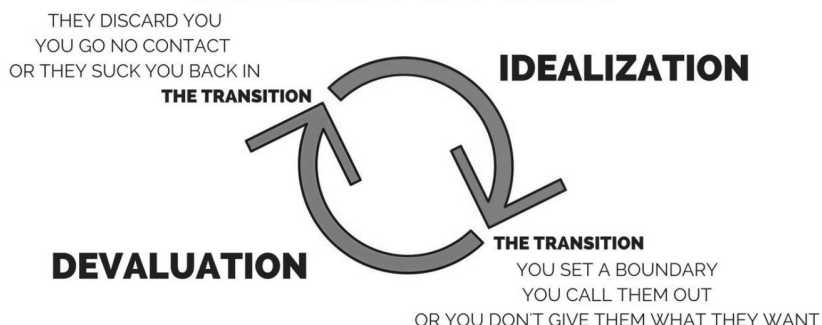
Margalis Fjelstad writes about the behaviors to look out for if you believe someone in your life is a narcissist on [\[3\]](#) *Mind Body Green*.

1. Narcissists feel the need to be the best or most at everything in their lives. Even if it means the sickest or injured, they must be at the top.
2. A narcissist constantly feels the need to acquire validation from a partner or important person in their lives because they subconsciously believed that they are not good enough. External validation is always required, but never enough. They will always want you to praise them because they cannot provide the confidence and assuredly for themselves, despite the outward appearance of confidence and egotism.
3. Narcissists are perfectionists, which means everything in their lives must be perfect and everything that they have planned or envisioned for themselves must play out without a hitch. This, of course, is not how life works, which often leads to the narcissist feeling dissatisfied. Perfectionism is why it is endlessly difficult for a narcissist to receive any criticism, even if it is constructive.
4. Because of the perfectionism, the narcissist wants to control everything around them, which includes a partner, a child, a parent, etc. This is where control in abusive relationships comes from because the behavior of the victim is not lining up with the exact ways the abuser wants it to.
5. Narcissists never take responsibility for their actions. Even if they contributed to the not so flawless way something may have been carried about, the fault is never their own; it is yours because you did do exactly as you were instructed. Noting they ever do can be wrong.

6. As previously stated, a narcissist cannot comprehend what boundaries are. They cannot comprehend that you have your thoughts, feelings, expectations, and past. They do not like it when another person expresses feelings that oppose their own because it is not perfect, which leads to more behaviors that attempt to control their entire world.
7. The narcissist lacks empathy, which is why they cannot understand boundaries. They cannot correctly read body language or facial expressions because they believe that other people must feel the same way they do. But they are also overly sensitive and aware of perceived rejection from others and constantly believe that the source of their negative feelings is caused by the person they are closest to in their life.
8. Logic does not work with the narcissist. Trying to explain to a narcissist how their behavior affects you is futile because they are only aware of their thoughts and feelings.
9. Splitting is a term used to describe how narcissists categorize every feeling, person, and experience into one of two categories: the good and the bad. This is due to their intense sense of perfectionism. Nothing can be a combination of a positive valence experience and a negatively perceived one. They can only cope with the single experience that is their own.
10. An appearance of surety and self-confidence hide the narcissist true experience of fear—fear of failure, losing money, their partner leaving them, their children being taken away, etc. No matter how close a person can get to a narcissist, they will never be able to build a trusting relationship simply because the narcissist is in constant fear of being abandoned.

11. Anxiety is a looming sensation for the narcissist who projects this sensation onto their siblings, partner, or parent. This is not an enjoyable sensation for the narcissist, so they rather throw it onto someone else.
12. Shamelessness may appear to be a trait of the narcissist, but it is truly an expression of the opposite. Shame means that there is something wrong about a person, and the narcissist cannot cope with this notion. Feeling shame is the enemy, so they do not allow themselves to feel it and bury it deep inside their subconscious. They hate that they possess insecurities and fear and live with this lingering sensation that becomes projected on the closest loved one who may 'find them out.'
13. Since the narcissist does not want to accept that they feel fear or insecurities, they cannot feel vulnerable. This makes it difficult to create and maintain close intimate relationships. The narcissist is constantly displaying this flawless sense of self-importance and perfection to the point where the true human beneath that is hidden from those that the narcissist considers the most important.
14. Lack of empathy means that the narcissist cannot work or communicate in a group setting because only their wants, needs, and thoughts are what truly exists in their world.

THE NARCISSISTIC ABUSE CYCLE



Narcissistic Victim Syndrome: When an Empath Meets a Narcissist

There exists an infinite amount of research and literature on narcissistic personality traits and narcissistic personality disorder, as well as the abuse inflicted upon those who get sucked into the cycle of abuse. But within the past decade, an interest in the effects of this form of abuse has arisen and thus has a specific diagnosis that pertains the narcissistic abuse: narcissistic victim syndrome.

Narcissistic Victim Syndrome (NVS) is defined as a group of symptoms experienced by a person who is closely related to a narcissist. This person could be a child, an adult, or even an elderly person experiencing abuse by a caregiver or their children. It is a newly discovered term that has very minimal literature associated with it. Clinically, it can have defined in the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual (DSM) under C-PTSD (class C of post-traumatic stress disorder).

The experience of this disorder is precisely how a victim feels when they have been emotionally/psychologically abused. It may take years for a victim to realize that they were being abused and then seek help for it because it is so unrecognized. ^[4]Kim Saeed



NARCISSISM

lists six signs that may indicate you are suffering from NVS, and therefore, have been dealing with an emotional/psychological abuse committed by a narcissist.

1. **Feeling alone.** The feeling of being alone is constant. Although your partner or person you care for may be around you, you are constantly wishing that someone will come and comfort you.
2. **You are not enough:** No matter how much success you have achieved in your life, your partner or person in your life does not recognize it, no matter what.
3. **Your entire life is the relationship.** Other interests, social events, and friends have evaporated and almost all of your mental and physical energy is put into 'fixing' or enduring the relationship.
4. **You compromise your values.** You stop standing up for what you believe in to make your partner/abuser content. You have stopped behaving in ways that you feel are valuable or even started participating in behaviors that they value in the name of 'being in love.' Examples of this are participating in sexual activities you never would have in the past, or you have stopped tipping at restaurants because your abuser disapproves of it.
5. **You feel unworthy due to name-calling.** Name-calling is meant to hurt you, no matter how many times a person in your life may claim that they are 'only joking' and that you are 'too sensitive'. There is nothing about their life that gives them the excuse to demean you, ever.
6. **You are exhausted by the cycle of abuse.** The constant cycle of abuse relies on the carousel ride of hurt and rescue. The abuser often applies the silent treatment as a tactic to evoke your fear of

abandonment, but then returns, making their victim feel relief. This cycle is repeated over and over again, which further weakens the resolve of the victim, lowering their standards and allowing more inappropriate behavior out of fear of abandonment.

If any of these feelings reside within you, you are dealing with emotional/psychological abuse. Because the diagnosis of the syndrome is so new, treatment options will vary. A narcissist is not as easy to identify as is written out in this book. Most narcissists, especially those in domestic relationships, initially appear wonderful—full of charm, excitement, romance, and security. It is only when you have been won over that the true hideousness that this person has been hiding will be revealed.

Falling for Them Again: The Codependent Relationship

Codependency is defined as excessive emotional and psychological reliance on a person, one of whom usually has mental or physical health issues or substance abuse disorder. A codependent romantic relationship is when a person derives confidence and self-esteem from taking care of their partner who may seem to be in constant crisis.

As previously described, narcissists are individuals who are only aware of their inner world—their emotions, their thoughts, their experiences, their memories. The concept of empathy is an empty void within their emotional capability, so relaying a narcissist how you feel is a waste of time, no matter how detailed your description may be. On the other hand, a person with a codependent personality is the opposite—the feeling of deep empathy and pride themselves on ‘fixing’ or ‘saving’ other people. Therefore,

relationships between narcissists and codependents often thrive based on their opposing traits that continuously feed upon one another's subconscious needs. An emotionally/psychologically abusive narcissist requires constant support and praise about their abilities due to their deep-seated fear of rejection, so the codependent feeds this need because they function and value themselves through helping others.

If your interpretation as to whether or not you or a friend who is being abused may possess these personality traits, take a read over these 6 identifying traits of a codependent individual, written by Shawn M. Burn from [\[5\]](#) *Psychology Today*:

1. You have an unearthly pattern of being responsible for other's behavior and to want to save them from their issues.
2. Your self-esteem gets boosted by the concept of self-sacrificing yourself for others.
3. You stay in detrimental caretaking relationships despite the negative toll on you and your relationships.
4. You consistently try to take care of troubled people whose issues are much larger than what you can handle alone.
5. You attract people who are seeking someone to take care of them.
6. You have a pattern of engaging with well-intentioned behavior to help others, but it constantly becomes unhealthy for you.

Codependents generally have a difficult time realizing that they attract narcissists in their lives, or that a parent or partner into the past may have begun this pattern of behavior. The complementary nature of codependents and narcissist makes it harder to identify and recognize when the

relationship is unhealthy and toxic. Everything flows perfectly, seemingly at least, so why would anyone want to stop it?

It takes a long time for codependents to identify what is occurring to them as abuse because they believe so strongly in the power of their dedication; they mistake self-sacrifice and giving for love. This can happen when a child takes care of a parent with an addiction, or a person believes they are taking care of their partner when they are being emotionally abusive. The codependent views them as needing to be saved, so they do, over and over again, waiting for the chance to receive an equal amount of dedication in return. This, of course, never comes because all the narcissist requires is to be taken care of and constantly reassured.

Codependents believe that they are only valuable through their actions—what they give, rather than being wanted as partner/child/friend for the positive qualities possess. Their low self-esteem allows them to believe that no one would love them for who they truly are, so they continue this constant giving toward their narcissistic partner. The partner or parent continues to thrive because, through the systematically emotional/psychological abuse, they can utilize a useful tool on their sensitive codependent. Guilt, name-calling, and belittling are all useful tools in the narcissist toolbox because it keeps the codependent in place, maintains low self-esteem, and maintains the flow of caretaking without reciprocation.

If you feel that you identify as a codependent, please read over the list written above a few more times. It is not uncommon for people to return to their abusers, whether it be in a relationship or familial relation. It takes

time to realize that your relationship is unhealthy and not a positive influence in your life. When this occurs in romantic relationships, especially long-term ones, it is normal for the abused/codependent to feel as if they could never find anyone in their lives that would treat them better.

This book is here to tell you that that statement is untrue. It is more than possible for you to self-reflect and to learn to identify behaviors and tendencies that led you back to engaging with narcissistic people. It is very possible to rebuild your sense of self-esteem and confidence that the narcissist managed to pull down your entire life.

Differences Between Other Disorders of Similar Nature: The Borderline and Histrionic Personality

Abusive personalities do not always fall under the category of a Narcissistic Personality. Several other disorders can be abusive and still manage to follow the cycled pattern of abuse. Here, three of the most commonly confused disorders will be discussed and how they relate to patterns of abuse.

There are gender biases when it comes to certain disorders and their diagnoses about behavior and how they can often be classified as gender specific. For example, women are more likely to be diagnosed with a histrionic personality disorder or borderline disorder than narcissistic personality disorder due to the expected emotionality of a woman. Men are more likely, as abusers, to be diagnosed with a narcissistic personality disorder because of the power privilege notion, where it is expected for men

to act more aggressively and controlling due to their gender. These gender disparities will be discussed more in-depth in a later chapter of the book.

Borderline Personality Disorder

Borderline Personality Disorder is a disorder is so dominant that it falls into the category of personality disorders within the diagnosis of the diagnostic statistical manual (DSM-V). Nine specific symptoms are described within the manual, which was published in 2013 (the most recent version). These symptoms are divided up into five separate categories, or domains, as they are termed within the DSM-V. Of the nine symptoms, a person must express five of them to be diagnosed with Borderline Personality Disorder. They are listed as follows:

Domain A: Constant, intense, unstable, and poorly regulated emotional reactions.

1. Affective instability that includes an extreme experience of anger, irritability, and anxiety/panic attacks.
2. Anger that is inappropriate contextually and difficult to regulate and control
3. Constant sensations of emptiness.

Domain B: Behavior that is impulsive, as well as harmful to the individual and others.

1. Excessive spending, unsafe sexual conduct, substance use, binge eat, and reckless driving.

2. Reoccurring suicidal thoughts and behavior, such as self-injury (cutting or hitting oneself), that are usually done when under stress.

This category includes any other behaviors that fall under the category of self-harm or behaviors that cause damage to properties or others.

Domain C: Distorted perceptions of self; high levels of suspiciousness.

1. A constant unstable self-image or sense of self, as well as self-identity.
2. Suspiciousness of others and what they think of you. Paranoid beliefs and constant stress related episodes during the individual feels like the surroundings are unreal.

Other symptoms that could fall under this category are all-or-nothing thinking difficulty lining up thoughts and an inability to develop rational problem-solving skills within social conflicts.

Domain D: The experience of tumultuous and extremely unstable relationships.

1. Going to extreme efforts to avoid real or imagined abandonment.
2. The individual may go back and forth between idealizing a relationship and severely undermining it. These relationships are

marked are intensity and instability.

An individual may also have heavily dependent traits and behavior in important relationships. The individual may expect negative behaviors from others and have difficulty reasoning clearly in stressful social situations.

As an Abuser

There is a similarity between Narcissistic Personality Disorder and Borderline Personality Disorder, which is the constant fear of abandonment. The difference between these two disorders is the reaction to the real or perceived concepts of that abandonment. A person with a borderline personality disorder is more likely to feel reactive because they are capable of some level of empathy and understanding where they perceive a person might leave them. A person with a narcissistic personality disorder may interpret this sensation and feel only concern for themselves and how the perceived behavior is making them feel.

It is believed that those with Borderline Personality Disorder have experienced some form of abandonment in their life that greatly stunts their emotional development as well as the ability to appropriately relate to others. It is said that due to their inability to control their anger, they are more likely than the general population to be verbally/emotionally/psychologically abusive.

An article was written by AJ Maharion, ^[6]*Mental Health Matters*, describes at length the link between this stunted emotional growth and the expression of rage when it comes to abusive behavior:

Intra-Psychic Pain: Sitting at the Root

If a person with Borderline Personality Disorder gets close to another, especially in an intimate romantic relationship, instead of experiencing feelings of joy and elation, they experience fear and panic. They are going backward in their minds to unresolved pain of abandonment that they had previously experienced. This raises maladaptive defenses that the borderline had previously applied in their past experience of pain. The fear, panic, and rage rise from the association with this past experience, almost any attempt to 're-do' correctly what they perceived as incorrect in the past. When a borderline person gets close to another, they are simply afraid that due to this closeness, something similar will happen to them that had previously happened in the past.

Borderline Rage

Anger is one of the main emotions experienced by a person with a borderline personality disorder. It is believed that this is due to an association with childhood responses, whereas rage acts as a primal feeling generated to protect the self and to entice the caregiver to return back to caring for the infant. It is believed that the anger expressed by a person with a borderline personality disorder is so intense because it precedes cognitive and verbal development.

Anger then becomes associated with survival. If the borderline has achieved closeness in a relationship with a non-borderline, if they exhibit behavior that is not 100% paying keen attention to their partner, this intense rage can

be triggered. It can be triggered by something minimal, but the borderline does not have a regulated sense of emotions and perceives this act as evidence of abandonment, so reverts back to an expression of this rage to help them survive. This rage is always sitting at the surface, which is why the experience of it can often be perceived by the partner as surprising and abrupt.

Abuse by the person with a borderline personality disorder is expressed differently. Some are very direct, with verbal insults, yelling and screaming, and throwing things, whereas others are more passive-aggressive with their rage. Borderlines do not have a gathered sense of self, that's why they can also experience sensations of dissociation. Their experience of past abandonment constantly messes with experiences of the presently perceived abandonment behaviors.

So then, a cycle goes on and on; anything short of intense symbiotic connection that is uninterrupted will cause the borderline to perceive the relationship as going downhill, so the anticipation of the pain occurs as well as the pain associated with the actual abandonment. Abusive behaviors are more likely to occur during the times the combination of rage and vulnerability hit an apex. It repeats itself, as the borderline has no idea what they are doing at the time connotes abuse. Some are capable of self-reflection and realize that they have acted poorly. But, in general, those are not aware of their emotions or how they can behave differently or help themselves in the future. Oftentimes, due to the abuse, the abused actually do leave the borderline, which leads to their worst fears coming into fruition and the likelihood of self-injurious and suicidal behavior.

As the Abused

A study done in 2016 found that emotional abuse was the most significant type of abuse in later diagnosed borderline personality disorder. Those who have experienced sexual and physical abuse who have adult diagnosed borderline personality disorder exist as 40-76% in those who were sexually abused and 25-73% in those who were physically abused. The most studied form of abuse and the link between borderline personality is maltreatment and neglect, whose relationship has been conclusively demonstrated.

Although there is not a lot more conclusive evidence of the link between childhood emotional/psychological abuse and the development of borderline personality, there are several attempts at exploring the symptoms and links behaviorally.^[7] Helena Wang wrote an article on the proposed link between childhood abuse and BPD by describing Rejection Sensitivity and Negative Affectivity:

Rejection Sensitivity

This trait of vulnerability is high amongst those diagnosed with borderline personality disorder. It is marked as being even higher than those with anxiety disorders. This trait is characterized by an intense expectation of rejection from others and a higher likelihood to interpret behaviors as rejection by their peers in social interactions. Due to this sensitivity, the child will misinterpret ambiguous social interactions as being the favor of rejection, where in reality it is mild or nonexistent. They often find social interactions be more stressful than their peers. Emotions such as frustration, anger, or anxiety expressed by a peer can easily be seen as rejection.

Generally, children with this sensitivity will develop two main coping mechanisms: avoidance and over-attachment. Both are present within the behavioral framework of a person with a borderline personality disorder and often diagnosed within the same person. They can simultaneously express these coping mechanisms as they grow older in ways of avoiding social interactions to stay away from the possibility of rejection while also forming intense close relationships with a select few friends. They simply want both a close relationship and fear it at the same time.

Negative Affectivity

This trait is described as possessing a tendency to be easily bothered by emotionally triggering events and feel associated with negative emotions concerning those triggers. This is the trait that is responsible for the intense experience of emotions that the BP experiences. When children with higher negative affectivity are emotionally/psychologically abused their emotional and social growth is hindered and continue to feel these intense emotions and become easily triggered by other emotions. A child with less negative affectivity will consequently be less likely to have their emotional and social development hindered, and thus, less likely to develop a borderline personality disorder.

Thought suppression, a form of therapy applied to treat borderline personality disorder, was once known to significantly decrease the effect of negative affectivity during the development of borderline personality disorder. The practice is when individuals attempt to consciously disassociate themselves from their negative thoughts. This act is overall maladaptive and harmful for the individual practicing it, as well as for anyone with mental health issues. This is because encouraging further disassociations will make it harder to switch the borderline individual back into feeling their emotions and learning to deal with them directly.

Histrionic Personality Disorder

Histrionic Personality Disorder is a personality disorder described in the DSM-V. This is significantly less known than the other three described in

this section, especially when it relates to emotional abuse.

The DSM-V states that for a diagnosis of histrionic personality disorder, five or more of the following listed symptoms must be present:

- Severely self-centered; feels uncomfortable when the attention is not on them.
- Constantly seeks approval and reassurance
- Often dresses inappropriately in a seductive manner/behaves in an overly inappropriate seductive manner
- Constantly altering emotional states that appear phony to others.
- Overly obsessive about physical appearance. Uses appearances to draw attention to themselves.
- Opinions are easily influenced by others
- Expresses exaggerated emotions
- Is highly suggestible
- Tends to believe that relationships are more intimate than they actually are

This personality is more commonly diagnosed in women, but it is believed that this is due to the gender disparity previously noted. Attention-seeking and sexual assertiveness are less socially acceptable for women, therefore, when this is present, it is faster to be seen as a behavior of a disorder in women than in men.

Usually, people with this personality disorder seek treatment for secondary issues, like when their relationship with their romantic partner ends. They can develop depression due to the overly inflated notion of certain relationships in their lives. It is difficult to note when an occurrence is realistic with a person with this disorder because they often exaggerate. They often cannot see a situation in a realistic light. The form of therapy usually applied for those with a histrionic personality disorder is psychotherapy due to the commonality of them seeking treatment for their depression. They may break boundaries set by the therapist and feel emotionally needy toward the therapist.

As the Abuser

Those with histrionic personality disorder are not often identified as abusers because of their emotional sensitivity—a tendency toward depression, the tendency to be overly dramatic and emotional, as well as their sensitivity toward criticism. There have been links in diagnoses of histrionic personality with an antisocial personality disorder. Many people often confuse antisocial personality disorder with psychopathy. But, once again, about gender disparities, generally men were being diagnosed with anti-social personality. This was more than likely again due to stereotyping the way men and women are expected to behave. 2/3 of individual women who were treated and assessed also met the criteria for antisocial personality disorder.

As the Abused

There is a general link between childhood-suffered abuse and the development of personality disorders. Personality disorders are different from other disorders in the sense that they manifest intensely and throughout the entire expression of the person. Anxiety disorders, psychotic disorders, and mood disorders are focal and generally stay within a couple of portions of that individual's life. This allows treatment to be easier for these people because the disorder is not embedded within their personality. As previously discussed, there are several forms of abuse, and it is in several forms that different personality disorders are more likely to develop. In the case of borderline personality, antisocial, and schizotypal, physical, and sexual abuse was mainly associated. Neglect and maltreat, as well as emotional/psychological was mainly linked to borderline personality disorder. There is very little research done on the histrionic personality and its link to abuse, but it has been estimated in general that a histrionic personality, along with all the other personality disorders, can be linked to some form of childhood trauma.

Halting the Cycle: What to Do

The first step is to identify the cycle of abuse and to follow through on identifying your codependent tendencies. Here, both will be reiterated as was previously stated in other chapters. When a child or elderly person is being abused, it is harder for them to notice the cycle of abuse and put a halt to it themselves. Therefore, this section is relevant to those who may be

around a person of whom they are suspecting is being emotionally/psychologically abused.

In Domestic Relationships

As previously stated, the general cycle of abuse flows as tension building, incident, reconciliation, and calm. In a romantic relationship, it is more than likely most common to identify an emotionally/psychologically abusive situation during the incident and reconciliation situation. An article written about domestic violence/abuse from ^[8]*Help Guide* identifies questions one can ask about themselves or their partner:

- Do you feel afraid of your partner?
- Do you avoid topics out of fear of angering them?
- Do you believe you deserve to be hurt or not treated well?
- Do you wonder about your own sanity?
- Do you feel numb or helplessness?
- Does your partner humiliate you often?
- Does your partner blame you for their abusive behavior?
- Does your partner put you down for your accomplishments?
- Does your partner see you as an object rather than a person?
- Does your partner force you into sexual intercourse?
- Does your partner threaten you with violence?
- Does your partner threaten suicide?
- Does your partner keep you from seeing friends or family?
- Does your partner constantly check up on you?
- Does your partner have an unpredictable temper?

If the answer to most of these questions is yes, then it is likely that you are in an emotionally abusive relationship. Realizing this is very important. The very first step in recognizing that the behavior your partner is committing is abuse.

The next step is realizing that it is not your fault. There is never any circumstance in an abusive situation where the fault lies in the abused. This is a fallacy that the abuser attempts to convince their victim over a long period of cyclic behaviors. This is a huge step and usually, don't have a fair amount of effort through the support of loved ones. This must occur by no longer making any excuses for the abuse; no matter how unintelligent, unreliable, or undesirable you believe you are, there is no excuse for behavior that is abusive. The abuser wants you to think that no one else will be able to love you as they do, therefore, you do not think leaving is possible or practical. This is the key to the narcissist's malevolent tactics.

Once it is recognized that you are being abused, and you are convinced that it is not your fault, it is time to begin documenting everything. Now, the concept of leaving is realistic and possible. This is very important if you have children or are married. Journal entries are a tactic, or even audio/visual recordings, if possible, are good ideas should it be available. If the abuse is physical, attaining a restraining order would be very important too. Keep the documents in a safe place that your partner cannot locate or even at someone's house that you trust.

Packing an emergency bag is very important. This too can be kept at a person's house in whom you trust. Keep anything essential to a couple of days or even a week of functioning, such as medication, identification, and

money. Abusive situations can escalate very quickly, and you have to be ready to leave at a moment's notice.

Alerting your family and friends is a good decision once you or someone who is being abused can admit that they are in an abusive situation. The support of people you love and who love you is highly important during this difficult time. The abuser may have been masterful at separating you from those you love to avoid support of leaving. Once you realize you are being abused, trying to reach out to family and friends again is something that may be difficult, especially if the abuser was successful in keeping you separated. But stay dedicated and realize that the separation created is another tactic your abuser applies.

Finally, the act of leaving and completely disengaging from this partner is the most crucial activity to participate in to begin the process of healing. The act of leaving is both physical and mental. An abuser can react to this separation with unkind acts or flowers in an attempt to continue the cycle of abuse. You should realize that these behaviors are them trying to bring you back and keep you controlled. Make the effort to block the abuser on social media, email, and phone number, along with your restraining order. Remind yourself that this person injured you, whether it be physically or emotionally. This person is not going to stop their behavior. You cannot love them out of their abuse. The only way it will stop is for you to leave the situation and begin identifying your tendencies toward codependent behavior.

How to Avoid Manipulation

Beyond the realm of emotional abuse, there are various ways that you can detect how others are trying to manipulate you and how to avoid it. An article from the website ^[9]*The Power of Positivity* lists 11 ways that this can be done.

1. Don't fall into their trap. People who try to manipulate others will try to do so in any way possible. If you cannot avoid these people, especially those who are in your family or who you work with, try ignoring them or responding with something kind, rather than falling into their trap of reacting to their prodding. Their goal is often to get a rise out of you, so if you don't react in the way that they want you to. They will eventually leave you alone.
2. Start writing down what they say during conversations. Emotional manipulators will often use what has been said or contort what they believe has been said to benefit them. If you don't have this recorded, you could begin doubting yourself and believe the lies that they are telling you. If you start writing things down, you will have tangible evidence that they are trying to manipulate you.
3. They will more than likely become angry if you confront them with this information, but if you remain persistent and protect yourself from their reactions, they will stop trying to toy with you.
4. Steer clear. If it is possible, try to stay away from people that you feel are emotionally manipulative. If you are a person that feels you can read the energy of others, if you feel something negative coming off of them, try to stay away. Trust your intuition in knowing that this person is not good for your mental health. Do what you can in a workplace or familiar situation to avoid contact.

5. Call them out on their behavior. Emotional manipulators have more than likely rarely been called out for their abusive actions. If push comes to shove, you must stand up for yourself and inform them about how uncomfortable they are making you, and that you are aware you are being taken advantage of. Even if their reaction is greatly aggressive, at least you know that you indeed stood up for yourself and they know you are not going to take this kind of treatment anymore.
6. Avoid emotional attachment. This is easier to say when you first meet a person, and their true manipulative self-reveals itself early on. But if the person has successfully conned you, which is often the case in emotionally abusive situations, try your best to recognize that their behavior is not good for you, back away, and create healthy boundaries. The more attached you are to this person, the easier it will be for this person to manipulate you.
7. Meditate. Meditation can help you self-reflect and to look at yourself and others with compassion. It is helpful while dealing with an emotionally manipulative person because nothing they do will effect how you are feeling. Again, this person may tire of you and move on. It is not your job to change the person, so don't worry too much about the story behind why this person is the way that they are.
8. Inspire them. If you are feeling so inclined, perhaps you can suggest some methods you used to help yourself becoming your own best self. Again, it is not your job to change this person, but making positive suggestions could turn around the energy of negativity they are so used to thriving on.

9. Tell them “You’re right”. This may be hard for your ego, but if you let the manipulator know that they are right, you are instantly cutting off the drama portion of what they feed off of. There is no space for arguments, so they will tire of you.
10. Let go of harmful relationships. This is in relationship to a romantic or close relationship with a person of whom is very manipulative. Your mental health is important, and if you have tried to help this person and they continue abusing you, their fate is in their own hands. You should let go of this person and choose to find your way through life without being constantly emotionally drained and pained.
11. Develop a strong mentality. Insults or ways that manipulators try to wind people up will not affect you if you choose not to let it. If you are insecure or not confident, try to admit this to yourself so you can move forward and develop this to avoid allowing anyone else to use or hurt you.
12. Give yourself positive self-talk: A good mood can be completely ruined by a talented manipulator, so if they are making you feel particularly agitated one day, try various methods of self-talk with yourself. Try to remember that you are your person, and that your interpretation of yourself cannot be affected by a person who only has a selfish agenda. You can find various affirmations online or on apps on your phone. Like most of these tactics, you will eventually at least appear unaffected to the manipulator, so they will move forward and away from bothering you.

This chapter ends the discussion on what manipulation is, and manipulators use their tactics to get what they want. You may have observed some of the vulnerable traits in yourself, but now, you have learned ways in which you can combat this kind of behavior.



Chapter 6: The Art of Persuasion

This chapter is going to discuss the various techniques and skills that people utilize to persuade people into doing what they want. This term is often used in the advertising and marketing world, as ads are aimed to persuade viewers into believing the message and eventually purchasing the product. We will first discuss how people in our everyday lives use persuasion to influence our behavior, and then how it is used on a grander scale.

The difference between manipulation and persuasion lies within three factors:

1. The intent behind your desire to persuade the other person.
2. The truthfulness and transparency of the process.
3. The net benefit or impact on that person.

Persuasion is often seen as manipulation's less devious cousin because it can be done in a way that is less morally questionable and to achieve goals that do not only benefit the person acting upon it. For example, if your friend has dumped someone that you already didn't like and of whom you found out was being unfaithful, yet your friend is thinking about going back to them, without informing them of the reasoning, you could persuade your friend into not getting back with them. This action greatly benefits the friend, as it does you, because you no longer have to deal with this person. Manipulation, on the other hand, always has devious tactics and mostly involves the skillful use of lies. In a similar scenario, perhaps your friend is crushing on someone of whom you are attracted to. You manipulate your friend into not pursuing this person by telling them supposed rumors about

their terrible behavior. Your friend stops wanting them, so now you are free to pursue them. This is done only for your advantage and is thus very manipulative, as well as generally being considered immoral.

Persuasion is a word often referred to in advertising, marketing strategies, and social media platforms. The goal of any product, service, or social media influencer (which includes photographers, models, musicians, actors, etc.) is to catch an audience with what they are offering. Therefore, they must persuade anyone and everyone they can get the attention of, into finding what they are offering appealing. People in our lives also persuade us, sometimes, in ways that benefit both us and them or in ways that only benefit them, such as the tactics employed in advertising. Like manipulators, persuasion can involve various definitions of what is the truth.

Psychological Theories of Influence and Persuasion

The following is a list of 10 psychological theories of influence and persuasion, collected by Dave Striker of Changing Minds. These can refer to the philosophies employed by marketers or by individuals when trying to persuade or influence another person:

1. **Amplification Hypothesis:** Displaying certainty about a specific attitude when talking with another person will increase and further harden that attitude. If it is uncertain, the opposite will happen; the attitude will further soften off the other person. An example of this is when a person is expressing an opinion about a movie; you will vague

agree with one section of their opinion while you intensely agree with another that you feel is more accurate.

2. **Conversion Theory:** The minority in a group can affect influencing those in the majority. Usually, those in the majority who are most susceptible to being influenced are those who joined the majority because it was easy. Confident minority voices are those of whom are most effective in influencing others onto their side.
3. **Information Manipulation Theory:** This involves a person deliberately breaking one of the four conversational assumptions we make when interacting with others:
 - Quantity: Information is complete.
 - Quality: Information is truthful and accurate.
 - Relation: Information is relevant to the conversation.
 - Manner: Information is expressed in an easy way to understand, and non-verbal actions support the tone of the statement.

A simple example of this is when someone lies to get out of being punished for their behavior. A person will lie about missing a dinner party, by saying that they were recently dumped, so they avoid being scolded by friends and family.

4. **Priming:** A person can easily be influenced by stimuli that affect how they perceive short-term thoughts and actions. A good example of this is when a magician uses certain words throughout their performance, which primes people to think of that word when they perform their 'mind-reading' section.
5. **Reciprocity Norm:** This is very common and is the obligation most people feel to return favors when a favor is done for us.
6. **Scarcity Principle:** What you want is in short supply; retail sellers often use this tactic to make more people buy their product. This

makes people believe that they miss out on the chance to get a service or product if they do not act now.

7. **Sleeper Effect:** The persuasiveness of a message tends to fade over time, but the sleeper effect has shown that sometimes when a message becomes disassociated with a discredited source, the effect of the message becomes more powerful. For example, if someone tells me about the quality of a car, and I know that that person knows nothing about cars, I will not feel like its valuable. But, eventually, once I dissociate with who that information came from, I could feel that the information makes sense in my mind.
8. **Social Influence:** This one comes as a no-brainer. We are easily and strongly influenced by others base on how we perceive our relationship with the influencer. If a big company like Coca-Cola positively reviewed another company, we are more than likely to take their word for it because of their success and how we feel about them.
9. **Yale Attitude Change Approach:** This approach was based on many years of research conducted at Yale University. It found that several factors in persuasive speech influence the success of the messages:
 - The speaker should be credible and attractive to the audience.
 - Messages should not appear designed to persuade.
 - Present two-sided arguments and refute the identified ‘wrong’ argument.
 - If two people are speaking one after the other, it is best to go first.
 - If two people are speaking with a delay between them, then it is best to go last.
 - The nature of the audience should be as follows: easily distracted, lower intelligence, and good self-esteem, and

between the ages of 18-25.

10. **Ultimate Terms:** Certain words carry more power than others. There are three categories of persuasive words:
- God terms - Those words that carry blessings or demand sacrifice/obedience. Examples are the words 'progress' and 'value'.
 - Devil Terms - Terms that are despised and evoke disgust. Examples are 'fascist' and 'pedophile'.
 - Charismatic terms - Terms that are intangible and less observable than the God or Devil terms. Examples are 'freedom' and 'contribution'.

Techniques of Persuasion You Can Apply

The following is a list of techniques that are more applicable in an everyday scenario. Feel free to try them out in ways that are more or less wholesome and do not rely on the damaging of others:

1. **Appealing to Authority:** Important people or experts help your argument seem more convincing. You can use reliable research to appear as if (or perhaps you have) meticulously researched the subject and know what you are talking about.
2. **Appeal to Reason:** Facts, numbers, and direct information are very persuading to people listening.
3. **Appeal to Emotion:** This works more often when the person is particularly emotional. Trying to elicit an emotion that is motivating will help you get what you want from a person.

4. **Appeal to Trust:** Those who are close to you are going to trust your moves than those of who are less close. They believe you, so it is easier for you to persuade them.
5. **Plain Folks:** People are more likely to believe you if you appear to be more average; this means that you are relatable, rather than not.
6. **Bandwagon:** Using quotes on how many people like something or do sometimes help people believe an argument.
7. **Rhetorical Question:** These questions help state the obvious and make the listener believe that you know what they want.
8. **Repetition:** The repeating of information is more than likely going to help a person remember what is being told to them.

Remember, when you try to persuade someone, try to take into account your reasons for wanting to do so. This goes the same for manipulation. It is far less likely that you are going to fall into the dark personality categories that were previously described, so don't feel too guilty about wanting to read this book. If you are looking for more marketing strategies about persuasion, the internet is full of them.



Chapter 7: A History of Mind Control

When most people think about mind control, they think about psychics and superheroes. They think about people who can, somehow, get into the brain matter of another person, into their thoughts, and begin controlling what they are doing or thinking. This has a very magical sensation to it—a supernatural notion that many people believe are behind the secrets of what books and the internet call mind control. Unfortunately, there does not exist a kind of mind control that is most like the fables we see in film and books, so try to let that disappointment die down for now. What this chapter is going to explore is the division of the definitions of what is often categorized as mind control, while the immediate chapter that follows will introduce some specific techniques that you can apply in your daily life.

Project MKUltra

Also known as the CIA mind control program, these secret goings-on used human subjects experimentally, sometimes applying legal methods, other times not. These experiments were done to identify and develop drugs that could be used in interrogation settings and encourage confessions. The program officially began in 1953 and put to halt in 1973. The legitimacy was often questioned to the use of unwilling American and Canadian subjects of whom were often administered many mind-altering drugs isolated and abused many times. Many documents have since been destroyed when public attention was brought into the mix.

[\[10\]](#) One of those documents though from 1955 was somehow recovered and listed 17 goals of the experimentation and what results the created

substances must produce:

1. Substances which will promote illogical thinking and impulsiveness to the point where the recipient would be discredited in public.
2. Substances that increase the efficiency of mentation and perception.
3. Materials which will cause the victim to age faster/slower in maturity.
4. Materials which will promote the intoxicating effect of alcohol.
5. Materials which will produce the signs and symptoms of recognized diseases reversibly so they may be used for malingering, etc.
6. Materials which will cause temporary/permanent brain damage and loss of memory.
7. Substances which will enhance the ability of individuals to withstand privation, torture, and coercion during interrogation and so-called "brainwashing".
8. Materials and physical methods which will produce amnesia for events preceding and during their use.
9. Physical methods of producing shock and confusion over extended periods and capable of surreptitious use.
10. Substances that produce physical disablement such as paralysis of the legs, acute anemia, etc.
11. Substances which will produce a chemical that can cause blisters.
12. Substances which alter personality structure in such a way the tendency of the recipient to become dependent upon another person is enhanced.
13. A material that will cause mental confusion of such a type the individual under its influence will find it difficult to maintain a fabrication under questioning.

14. Substances which will lower the ambition and general working efficiency of men when administered in undetectable amounts.
15. Substances that promote weakness or distortion of the eyesight or hearing faculties, preferably without permanent effects.
16. A knockout pill which can be surreptitiously administered in drinks, food, cigarettes, as an aerosol, etc., which will be safe to use, provide a maximum of amnesia, and be suitable for use by agent types on an ad hoc basis.
17. A material that can be surreptitiously administered by the above routes and which in very small amounts will make it impossible for a person to perform physical activity.

The program essentially applied heavy use of various drugs on some unwilling individuals to develop substances and materials that have a heavy influence over their behavior. In this context, they wanted to get any supposed spy to confess and to flush out the truth against their own will.

Some of the more specific drugs and techniques applied within the MKUltra Program are as follows:

- **LSD:** The CIA focused heavily on this hallucinogenic drug because of its profound impact on those who have been known to use it. Lysergic acid diethylamide (LSD) was administered immediately in 1953 to psychiatric patients, prisoners, and those with drug dependency, as well as sex workers. The reason they chose these individuals was because they believed they 'could not fight back'. They also studied the reactions of other CIA employees, military

individuals, doctors, and other government agents. As previously mentioned, this was often done without the person's knowledge, which aided in the manipulation that took place once the effects of the drug had kicked in. In some instances, individuals were administered LSD without consenting, interrogated under bright lights, and told that they would further extend their trip if they did not reveal their deepest darkest secrets. In another instance, fake brothels were built on CIA headquarters, and after giving the agents LSD, observed them entering these areas that had been equipped with two-way mirrors. The goal of applying this drug was to help get the truth out of interrogations and to control agents and soldiers like a robot. LSD became less of a priority in 1962 when researchers realized that the results of LSD use were too unpredictable.

- **Amphetamine and Barbiturates:** A barbiturate is a drug that acts to depress the central nervous system, whereas amphetamine is a stimulant. Researchers would inject a barbiturate first into the subject, and once they began to fall asleep, injected the amphetamine. This experiment receives moderate success as the person would often awake suddenly, initially incoherent, but able to answer questions without much hostility.

- **Hypnosis:** The practice of hypnosis was utilized during many research sessions of MKUltra. The goal was creating fake anxiety, increase the ability to understand complex martial, and to observe the relationship between personality type and susceptibility to hypnosis. They also observed instances of induced amnesia. Hypnosis will be reviewed in further detail in the next chapter.

Many different hallucinogens, stimulants, and depressants were used on the subjects of MKUltra. All of this was done in the name of creating alternate reactions to the brainwashing attempts of the Soviet and Chinese government at the time. The lack of organization, the immorality, the lack of an ethical approach, and the destruction of documents made MKUltra an occurrence of whose impact is still not truly known. Many individuals' mental health was ruined for life, while an unknown number of deaths have echoed beyond its final decision to shut down in the 1970s. Alas, there were very minimal positive results of this program but inspired many popular culture references and backdrops many famous films and television series.

Brainwashing

This term is often lumped together with the notion of mind control. Like the MKUltra experiments, they do not involve a supernatural element that will allow you to make someone you don't like act silly in public, but various complex theories that work to influence another person's beliefs, which further influences their actions.

The original discussion on the notion of brainwashing was developed in the 1950s in an attempt to explain how the Chinese government seemed to make those around them comply with their desires. It was also observed by looking at the tactics of Nazi Germany, some criminal behaviors in the United States, actions of human traffickers, and abrupt conversions into the religious and cult movement. Brainwashing is generally not looked at as a psychological conduit but a pseudoscientific practice.

The first known use of the term brainwashing in the English-Language was by outspoken journalist Edward Hunter in 1950. In an article, he spoke about the Korean War and how some American prisoners of war had cooperated with their captors due to this supposed brainwashing. Researchers studied the various POWs who returned home after the Korean War and found little evidence to indicate that the opposing side had applied any methods of what could be classified as the brainwashing of an American.

The actual word brainwashing came from the Chinese word, which meant 'wash brain', was originally used to describe the persuasive government of Maoist China. Their goal was to transform those who were too 'reactionary' to people who were 'right-thinking' people. It was further popularized by the publishing of George Orwell's dystopian fiction, *1984*, released in 1959. Within the novel, the main character is imprisoned and tortured, so he conforms his thoughts to a fictional totalitarian society. This notion of mind control became enhanced once many films used brainwashing to turn prisoners of war against their homeland. Science fiction quickly used the concept of mind control as a strong theme in many novels between the 1940s and 1960s. This marinated the concept of

brainwashing within the minds of many observers as something entirely based in reality.

Famous Instances

Because the notion of brainwashing had been embedded in society's mind since the Korean War, as well as the growing awareness of the MKUltra project, lawyers began using the term as a method of defending their clients. One of the most famous instances of this is the influence that Charles Manson had over his followers, and of whom he supposedly brainwashed into committing murder as well as other crimes. Other known crimes, such as the kidnapping of Patty Hearst and the subsequent brainwashing she underwent to be influenced to rob a bank, brought the notion of negative influence into the public mind centrally.

Human Trafficking

A woman who is the co-founder of the United Nation's non-government run organization wrote a book in 1979 about the fluctuation of human trafficking. Kathleen Barry describes techniques that were very similar to those that had been used by supposed cult leaders, such as Charles Manson. Some of the techniques Barry explained are listed as follows:

1. Feigning love and concern for the victim's well-being
2. Gaining trust before beginning to track every aspect of the victim's life
3. Control of victim's environment, relationships, and daily activities
4. Promising financial gain

5. Corrupt marriage proposals
6. Keeping the victim in debt to the perpetrator
7. Induced drug dependency
8. Fear tactics that include threats about deportation, law enforcement, and harm to family members and friends
9. Physical captivity
10. Shaming and guilting
11. Stockholm Syndrome - the development of a hostage to develop a psychological alliance with their captors during captivity.
12. Traumatic Bonding - this occurs as a result of ongoing cycles of abuse when the intermittent reinforcement of reward and punishment creates an intense bond, that is often resistant to change.

These techniques have also been observed to occur within cult groups that formed around the 60s and 70s, as well as some that may be thriving today.

A Psychological Description

In simplicity, the notion of brainwashing is noted within the canals of psychology as social influence. Social influence is something that happens constantly, every day, wherever you go. What it relies on is not a single magical spell or technique that moves you in an entirely opposing directly instantaneously. It is a collection of methods that are used to alter a person's behavior, attitudes, beliefs, and behavior. Within this definition, it is easy to see how the previously describes methods of persuasion and manipulation

fall under the concept of brainwashing. It is not always going to be something as high-brown and hush like government experiments; it could be your parent, your partner, or even your friendly neighborhood marketing team.

Marketing and Advertising Techniques

In today's infinitely developing society of gadgets that seem to allow us to do everything and have access to every piece of information we desire, it is becoming increasingly easier to develop ways to influence consumers all over the globe. Most things that we like, don't like, our opinions on certain political climates, on certain musical artists, movies, fashion senses, and even what type of lawnmower you use, are publicly available for anyone and everyone to see. Who we are, essentially, is plastered all over the Internet, which is a vast universe of at the fingertips of advertisers. Targeted advertising is much easier because being grabbed by an ad or offer can happen at any second of the day—through our phones, computers, TVs, or even when walking down the street near a billboard.

Mind control then within the world of marketing only needs to rely on a few psychological theories to reach out to their target audience. 14 of those are listed by Sydney Hatch of [\[11\]](#) *Disruptive Advertising*:

1. **The People Mirrors:** It has been a long-known fact that people tend to mirror the emotions of those around, particularly, the ones they know best. Within this digital age, many people express their emotions through social media platforms, such as Facebook and Twitter. This concept seems to exist within the confines of these

platforms, with the absence of verbal cues and body language. Facebook engineers tweaked what over 600,000 users saw in their feeds so that more positive valence emotions were being seen. What was observed was staggering; those who saw more positive posts expressed more of their positivity, while those of whom observed mainly negative posts expressed negative emotion on their pages. The researchers called this emotional cognition.

2. **The Jingle Jam:** A great way that companies get their customers to remember them is through the use of a catchy jingle. These are often so short and so catchy, that many people will recall the product and the ad years after the ad stops airing. Phone numbers, services, and sales are all recalled specifically due to a song that gets stuck in our heads. Psychologically this refers to the famous experiment of Ivan Pavlov and his dogs, where he rang a bell and then gave the pets a piece of meat. Eventually, he was able to condition the dogs to salivate after merely hearing the bell ring. An association was created, and this has been called classically conditioning.
3. **The Psychology of Color:** This branch of psychology studies hues as a determinant of human behavior. Within the world of marketing, certain shades have been associated with certain emotions, especially ones that enhance the customer experience and increase in purchasing of products. Several industry norms have been tested for validity, such as the belief that red creates an emotion of urgency and that yellow is for Internet window-shoppers.
4. **The Fear of Missing out Feeling:** Feeling excluded is an emotion that everyone can relate to. Marketers take advantage of this by making a consumer seem like they are somehow missing out on a product, service, or activity that everyone around them is partaking in.

This may be the truth, or the projection may be a false reality. Retail outlets do this placing only a minimal number of products on a shelf, just in case you fear that the store will run out, where Internet ads warn you about the sale that is 'almost over'. An impulse buy phenomenon tries to trigger the fight or flight sections of people's brains.

5. **The Subtle Design:** Most people in modern society do not want to believe that they are being fooled. Companies will use simple logos and implement subliminal messages, which are messages that are not easily perceived. This can be interpreted visually within a logo, in a store with certain sights, sounds, and smells.
6. **The Sale:** Is it hard for you to resist a good sale at your favorite store? Don't worry, that is the case for most people. A theory in psychology called encoring states that people base decisions on the first piece of information they get. This happens in advertising when there are sales, and the initial price is placed next to the new, more appealing price. People are more likely to feel satisfied that they managed to save a good amount of money than just buying a product for its listed price.
7. **The Consistency Comfort:** All humans are creatures of habit. Of course, this helps in the world of advertising. Companies who follow a consistent look and theme of their product or service are much easier to trust and recall than ones that are all over the place.
8. **The Need of Images:** People remember what they see 80% of the time more than the recollection of the 20% that they read. If a website or store is not visually appealing, people are less likely to want to shop there. Most ads on the street will utilize an image more than too much text.

9. **The Serial Exposure:** There is a reason that you see the same ads when you are watching your favorite TV program or going through various YouTube channels. If you are exposed to something more often, you are more likely to like it. If there is a certain style of shoes that you initially didn't like, but see them all the time, you are more likely to begin liking them than to continuing detesting them.
10. **The Power of Choice:** People want to be independent, so advertisers, especially nowadays, have worked in various ways of allowing the customer to feel like they are in control. The options on menus and websites for various products are also limited because there is a point when too many options begin to detract from the experience.
11. **The Emotion Message:** Many studies have been conducted on ads and have shown that most people will respond to ads that have an emotional message, rather than those that have an intellectually one. Emotions help us make decisions, so we as humans often rely on them when we are purchasing a product or service. Depending upon your age and gender, certain ads will attempt to appeal to you more than others.
12. **The Created Community:** People want to belong to groups, as we are all social beings. As this is not always a conscious effort, try thinking about an ad that you feel related to you. If you are a woman who has tattoos and piercings, and you see a woman who looks just like you in an ad about a certain music app or other product, you are more than likely going to recall that ad. This phenomenon is known as social herding.
13. **The Give and Get:** Most people feel uncomfortable if someone gives them a gift and they do not have one for them in

return. This is called reciprocity, which is the idea that we naturally want to do nice things for people who have done nice things for us. Companies use this emotion by giving out free samples to customers or by offering a discount code. Nothing that is based on purchasing something, but often makes people feel like they need to buy something while within the store.

14. **The Power of Three:** Many advertisers use odd numbers to display products and to fool you into choosing the price of a more expensive product. They will place three options next to each other, making one look like a deal while the third may be somewhat useless and used to make you choose something costlier.

Techniques to Be Aware of

As you have now learned, there are many ways that people, companies, groups, strangers, and friends use the techniques of mind control to get what they want. It may be impossible to become completely aware of them, especially when it comes to advertising, but in your personal life, there may be people who are trying to control you. They may be so good at it that you are not aware of it.

As previously mentioned, there is a difference between manipulation, influence, and persuasion. There are many innocent forms of persuasion and influence, such as the methods parents apply to get their kids to eat

their vegetables. But when it comes to the manipulation and many other forms of control, the effects can be felt life-long and can be difficult to overcome. The following is a list of mind control techniques, many in which you may recognize from the section that discusses emotional abuse by a narcissist:

1. **Isolation:** This can be very powerful; it can be done physically or mentally. Many parents do it to their children when they have their issues with insecurity and loneliness. This is a useful way for the person to control how much information you are receiving from others.
2. **Criticism:** This may be used as a mentally isolating tool. The manipulator will usually speak in 'us vs. them' terms and criticize the outside world. This keeps you within their grips, so you do not develop any form of independent thought outside of them.
3. **Social Proof and Peer Pressure:** A person who is trying to manipulate a large group of people uses this to keep newcomers engaged. Social proof is when some people assume that the actions and beliefs of others are appropriate because everyone is doing it. As previously mentioned, this is also known as peer pressure in more youthful circles.
4. **Fear of Alienation:** A manipulative group will use the supposed depth of a relationship or friendship against a person, should they have doubts or desires to leave the group. The person may fear to leave the group because of the perceived loss of these connections.
5. **Repetition:** This is simple but very effective. As stated in the advertising section, something that is heard more often is going to be remembered more than something that is stated only once or twice.

More proof of this working is the reference to affirmation; the more you tell yourself something, the more likely you are going to believe it.

6. **Fatigue:** Human beings are a lot more susceptible to persuasion, influence, and manipulation when they are physically and mentally tired. The brain hasn't had a chance to recover, so its defense mechanisms and cognitive abilities are greatly softened.
7. **Forming a New Identity:** Essentially, when a person is trying to manipulate you, they want to mold you into an entirely new person. This is not in a positive sense, as their desire leans on the side that wants you to act like a robot; not to question anything that is said or done, and to succumb to whatever it is they may want. This happens systematically over time, especially in groups where a leader is trying to influence many people at once.

Other Forms of Mind Control

Other techniques are applied within the world of politics, advertising, and everyday instances that attempt to influence the opinions and behavior of others. You more than likely have heard the terms used before.

Hypnosis

This is an accident and complicated human phenomenon that involves focused attention, reduced awareness, and a high likelihood of suggestibility. Many arguments state that people are in when under hypnosis; some believe that they are in a trance, while others see it as a different plan of consciousness.

The act has also been historically controversial, as some theorists state that hypnosis is the result of the placebo effect (the ability to implant an idea into a person's mind), and a redefining of the interaction with the therapist. Various disorders such as dissociative identity disorder (controversial known as multiple personality disorder) have been theorized to have been created by a therapist who had placed their patients under hypnosis.

You have probably heard the term before and thinking about a person swinging a watch in front of someone's face and telling them to do strange things for a captive audience. This is hypnosis and falls under the category of mind control because it implies and seems to possess magical traits. It is best, though, to try to think of hypnosis as a state of consciousness. Just like being asleep is one state of consciousness as is the in-between states, like when you are watching TV and falling asleep or state long enough at something relaxing and your awareness of your surroundings diminish. If you can think about these sensations that you would feel during these moments, then you can relate to how it feels to be hypnotized.

As you are under a trance, you are focusing more and more on what is occurring inside your mind than what is occurring around you. This is often used as a therapist's tool because it usually helps a person relax when recalling traumatic memories, as well as help them to feel calm after a stressful day.

Although this is a state that is commonly felt and mainly positively valance, some elements can fall under the behavior that is malevolently intended. When a person is under this trance, as stated, their ability to think critically and logically is very dim. This makes them highly suggestible and willing

to accept any suggestions made to them, without assessing or truly comprehending what they are being asked to do. Thinking about some naturally occurring trances can help you understand what being under hypnosis may feel like, such as driving and arriving upon a destination due to muscle memory or feeling incredibly relaxed and inwardly focused during a massage.



Hypnosis can be very relaxing and innocent, but if it falls under the wrong hands, there are ways it can be negatively utilized.

Subliminal Messaging

Subliminal messages are stimuli that lie below our conscious threshold of awareness. There is a great mysticism surrounding subliminal messages, as there is with the concept of brainwashing and hypnosis. The main association with this concept is the fear that advertisers are inserting these ideas into our subconscious, and we are being controlled by them. There is a vast difference between the notions of subliminal and supraliminal messaging; a person cannot perceive something as subliminal, even if they are looking for it. An example of something that is supraliminal, meaning when a person is subconsciously influenced is when a certain kind of music is played that promotes the purchase of a certain kind of food. If Indian music was played, more people bought Indian food. If Jamaican music was played, more people bought Jamaican food. This is not subliminal because the people could still perceive the music. They were just not subconsciously aware of its influence.

Subliminal messages cannot be perceived, and there are generally three types of them:

1. **Sub-Visual Messages:** Visual cues that are quickly flashed so people do not perceive them.

2. **Sub-Audible Messages:** Low volume audio cues that are inserted into louder sounds.
3. **Backmasking:** An audio message recorded backwards, with the intention of playing it forward in order to disguise the reversed messages.

Research of subliminal messages seems too often include the notion of sex. The reasoning behind this is the idea that the association of sex with any product automatically makes the product more appealing.

Although there is still a discussion as to the authenticity of this claim, there are many other instances where more forms of subliminal messaging have influenced the behavior of others. Some examples are as follows:

1. [Fitzsimons, Chartrand, and Fitzsimons \(2008\)](#) found that people were able to list significantly more uses for a brick when they were subliminally primed with the logo from Apple (compared to IBM's logo). This happened because apparently, the subliminal exposure to Apple's logo temporarily enhanced people's creativity.
2. [Murphy and Zajonc \(1993\)](#) found that people developed a more favorable opinion of ambiguous symbols after they were subliminally flashed with smiling individuals. In fact, this effect was stronger when the exposure was subliminal.
3. [Bornstein, Leone, and Galley \(1987\)](#) found that people agreed more with a person after they were subliminally flashed with a picture of him or her.
4. [Legal, Chappé, Coiffard, and Villard-Forest \(2011\)](#) subliminally primed people with the words "to trust". The result was that those

people found a message about tap water consumption to be significantly more persuasive.

Cult and Group Brainwashing/Mind Control

Assault on Identity: This was previously mentioned and is very important if the manipulator wants to entirely control and own the behavior of their victims. The American prisoners were physically abused and tortured to the point of doubting themselves and their own identities. This was done by intentionally contradicting what they were saying at any and every turn.

The Establishment of Guilt: It was reported that a huge dose of guilt was imposed on many prisoners during the Korean War. This made them believe, at some point, that they deserved to be punished. This is done by making the person responsible for their faults and the things that go wrong in their life. Everything wrong is their fault, and guilt is the emotion that captors/manipulators can use to their advantage.

The Self-Betrayal: At this point, captors tried to make the prisoners denounce people that they were close to. This would help alienate them from the people in their lives and also further establish the sensation of guilt. Any doubt that they may have, no matter how small or how far away into the past it was, the captors use this to convince them that their beliefs and values no longer align with the people they once felt they were close to. This increases the sensation of self-betrayal, a feeling that slightly resembles guilt and shame. This tactic would separate them from their past and further deconstructs their sense of self.

Breaking Point: Total Conflict and the Basic Fear: At some point, a prisoner would realize that there is not out from their experiencing of guilt, trauma, and fear. They start to feel something that initially sounds incredibly abstract; they fear the total annihilation of the self. What this means is that the collection of traits, values, ideas, and characteristics that make them who they are almost completely fragmented. Many prisoners at this point will feel suicidal. Others will suffer from delusions and hallucinations. Their ability to think rationally and to comprehend what is truly happening to them is greatly diminished at this point.

Leniency and Opportunity: When prisoners feel like they may be at a breaking point, there comes a person who offers something so minimal, such as a friendly voice or face, a small luxury such as a cigarette or drink, they abruptly feel a tiny sense of hope. Because they felt they were almost at the edge of destruction, the captors use this as an opportunity to ‘save’ them. They try to convince the prisoners that the new way is the way to go, and even more importantly, that the new way will keep them alive.

The Compulsion to Confess: Prisoners tend to confess to anything during torture and deprivation because they feel the need to get anything that is deemed negative out of their system. They even invent crimes that did not occur. The more they confess, the more confessions that keep coming out. Captors would try to get prisoners to encourage one another to keep confessing.

The Channeling of Guilt: The more the prisoners try to embrace the new way of thinking, the more guilt they felt for who they were before. They begin recounting their old ways of thinking and behaving because of the

immense guilt that follows them, the more they try to embrace the new way of thinking.

Re-Education: Logical Dishonoring: This is the point where guilt transforms into shame for past actions and for the captors to convince the prisoners that this behaving was violating their ideals. This is based upon the belief that every human has their moral code, and that is always something that opposes it, working against their code inside our consciousness. The captors would attempt to wear down this moral code and give life to the opposing side of ourselves; the side that we usually try to suppress. As this becomes more dominant, the true self is even more suppressed. This is cyclic; the activation of guilt, and the reinforcement of a new personality, so the prisoners would become exactly who their captors desired them to be.

Progress and Harmony: As the prisoners continue to progress into this newly molded personality, the techniques of brainwashing alter, so then the captors begin accepting and recognizing the prisoners as actual human beings. This fair and peaceful treatment motivates the captors to continue behaving this way and forging a new path with a new belief system in place.

Final Confession: The Summing Up: This final confession occurs, coming from the new identity, rather than the identity who confessed out of fear of death. The prisoner describes the past self with guilt and gratitude toward their new sense of self. From their new perspective, renouncing their former self appears to be logical and meaningful.

Rebirth: The prisoner feels whole again. Their reality is entirely different as are their thoughts and values. They have an entirely different relationship with the world and approach from this new and seemingly refreshing perspective.

Release: This is when the prisoners are allowed back into the world but re-experience from the point of view from this new personality.

People who were previously in their lives have returned but are treating them as if they are their old personality. This experience was reportedly very traumatic for many ex-prisoners of war, as their new ideas and personality are being questioned by those around them. This could lead to many issues with depression, anxiety, post-traumatic stress disorder, and other mental health problems.

Mind control in this instance is done to construct a pseudo-personality that fits with the ideas and beliefs of the person doing the manipulating. This occurs often in cults and makes the younger generation much more susceptible, as their beliefs and values are criticized, being told that they were forced upon them by society and their parents. Leaders take advantage of this desire for independence and attempt to mold them into entirely new people.

Sometimes, violence and abuse are used as brainwashing tools. These are often used over time and strategically, at a point where the person being abused is led to believe that what is being done to them is happening for their good. This happens not only in cults but sometimes to children who are abused and manipulated into believing the abuse is normal and allowed.

The following are other techniques that were not mentioned in the previous list and POW scenario. These are used in cults and group manipulations as well:

- Deceit: A victim will believe that they are getting one thing, whereas they are getting something entirely different.
- Love Bombing: Showering new members of a group with affection and excessive love that makes them feel unique and special.
- Childish games that make the victim behave immaturely, that also encourage obedience to the leader.
- No questions or criticisms about the leader are accepted.
- New members are often followed around and constantly speaking to by new experienced members, so they are not given any time alone to introspect.
- Cults will often ask for a financial commitment and connect it to a psychological or spiritual commitment.
- Loaded Language: Complicated ideas are summarized into smaller sentences and explanations that allow the members to think and reflect less.
- Chanting, singing, and dancing as ways to take up the time of a person do, they do not engage in critical thinking.
- Repetition of ideas.
- Spying on others and reporting to the leader to show off obedience.
- The shaping of dependency by going back and forth between punishment and rewards for the same kind of behavior.
- Unpredictable behavior by manipulators.
- No criticism of the new ideas is allowed.
- Various threats that seem to come out of nowhere.

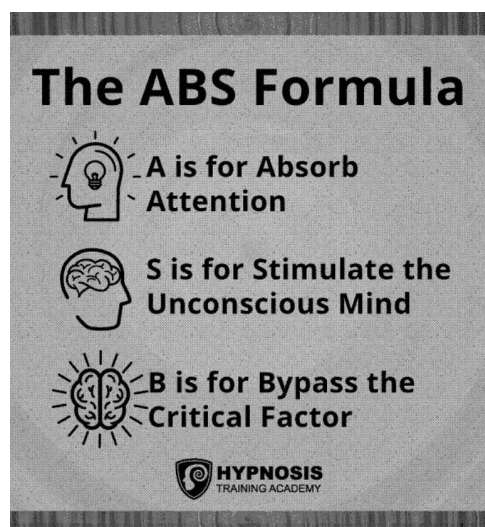
- Small rewards for desired behaviors, punishments for unwanted ones.
- Victims are usually ignorant as to what is going to happen to them next due to a plethora of unpredictable elements of the group's mentality.

Mind control as a summary then is a term that umbrellas many actions meant to manipulate, influence, course, and/or persuade. It is subtle, and in most cases, malevolently intended. An attempt to exert any of these forms of mind control over someone involves extended periods. It is sneaky because it generally convinces a person that they are thinking of themselves, whereas, a few carefully placed words, phrases, conversations, and techniques have skewed their perspective into doing exactly what the perpetrator intended.



Chapter 8: Mind Control Techniques

You have finally arrived upon the section you have been waiting for, the section where you can begin practicing your mind control techniques. It is the hope of the writer that you have learned by now that the concept of mind control is not like the casting of a magic wand in the air. It is not simple, nor does it turn our friends or enemies into mindless zombies. In the following section, we re-introduce a few of the techniques previously mentioned and explore a few specific techniques you can use in your day-to-day living. These are the positive elements of observing the actions of those who are skilled at manipulating, persuading, coercing, influencing, and sometimes, completely emotionally abusing. We are going to string together silver line from a very dark cloud and learn a few skills that help our lives enhance for the better.



Hypnosis

As previously mentioned, you more than likely associated hypnosis with a magician's trick or a psychic's way of paying the bills. But it is more often

used within the medical sector to help people deal with a vast array of psychological problems.

Here, we are going to list a step-by-step guide that can help you practice the art of hypnosis and learn that there is not anything mythical about it—it's all about the capabilities of the human brain.

[\[12\]](#) *The Hypnosis Training Academy* introduces an ABS formula that anyone can follow if they want to learn how to hypnotize someone:

A - absorb attention

B- bypass the critical factor

S - stimulate the unconscious mind

There are also three elements that are involved within a single hypnosis session:

1. **The Induction:** Bringing the subject into a trance (it is emphasized that although the word 'trance' does seem to fall under the magical category, it is just a phrase used to relay that a person is within a highly suggestible state).
2. **Change Work:** Where you use hypnotic suggestions and other techniques to make some kind of change.
3. **Exit:** Where you bring the subject out of the trance.

We will now explore all three elements of a hypnosis session by referencing the ABS formula:

The Induction

This is where we are going to try to follow A: absorbing someone's attention. As previously mentioned, we as human beings can enter hypnotic states on our own, without any swinging watch or psychic influence. This relies on the change of focus.

If you focus hard on doing something you love, such as painting, writing, or singing, the rest of the world disappears. Your focus is shifting from the conscious world to the unconscious world inside your mind and body.

It is when you don't notice your mom yelling out for dinner or your dog poking at your leg while you're writing. To do this intentionally to another person though, you have to get their attention.

There are many ways that you can try to do this; you can tell them a joke, show them a picture, ask them to look into your eyes, etc. If it is not a formal setting and is not a friend or family member you are trying to hypnotize, you can politely go up to someone and tell them you want to ask them a question or that you need their help with something. Try to look directly into their eyes when saying this. Most people are curious, so they will engage with you.

If you are doing this formally, simply tell the subject to close their eyes, and that by doing so, they are beginning the process of sliding into a trance. By associating the closing of the eyes with a hypnotic trance, the person is already opening themselves up to the concept of being hypnotized. This also shows they trust you, which will make the process easier.

Once you have their attention, you can move onto B: bypassing the critical factor. The critical factor is referring to the conscious mind. The conscious mind is the part of you that can judge, criticize, and weigh the pros and cons

during decision making. Sometimes, though, constantly analyzing situations with the conscious mind can get a person stuck. So, unlike the conscious mind, the unconscious mind does not evaluate or judge. It will accept whatever is told to it and goes to work to get it done, albeit anything that goes against your values or ethics.

Engaging with the unconscious mind is the entire point of hypnosis. You can do that by telling an engaging story, using hypnotic themes such as focus, relaxing, learning, or to sprinkle in your speech with what is called hot words, and/or power words.

Hot words are said to stir up emotions. These words are descriptive and can make a person feel emotional.

Power words are words such as 'because,' 'as,' and 'imagine that' connect ideas. They help build a picture in someone's mind and this helps stimulate the unconscious.

Most people begin by telling a story because telling a story can easily capture the attention of the subject, allowing their conscious mind to fade into the background. The story can be about you, about someone else, or something you've read about. It is meant to be short and simple and able to capture the attention of the subject without too much confusing detail.

Now, you can move onto S: stimulation of the unconscious mind. You have already sorted doing this in the previous section by telling a story to your subject. A more benevolent reason to use hypnosis is to help people change something critical in their lives. The reason why people find it difficult to

make changes in their lives is that they believe they have already done everything and/or they do not believe in themselves. Using hypnosis begins a journey of looking for answers within the unconscious mind rather than continuing to rely on the conscious one. There are infinite possibilities and create methods of problem-solving that you can tap into using the unconscious mind.

How long you have to stay within the relaxation portion of the session will depend on the person who you are hypnotizing of course. Some people with anxiety issues may find it harder to calm down, so you will hover within the relaxation element for a time. Some people who have previously been hypnotized may find it easier to fall into a trance, especially since you are someone that they trust.

Change Work Process: Using Hypnotic Suggestions

Once the person is in a trance, you are already to offer them suggestions. This is where you are going to implant ideas into their subconscious mind that are directives to engage in before, after, and during the trance. A directive during a trance may be to focus on their breath or the hypnotizer's voice. After trance examples are when you tell the subject to remember the nasty taste of cigarettes the next time, they go to light one up. Creating hypnotic suggestions will come before you start the session, so the subject can share with your images and wordings that they feel would act like the most successful within their trance. You will use your imagination by stimulating the subject's imagination, filling out some vague outlines of the scene for the subject to fill in themselves. You will use the reception of

ideas and images because repetition is what will stick within a person's mind.

An example of this may sound like:

“Now close your eyes and go deeper into your trance. I am going to touch your hand as a cue to go deeper. Let yourself finally relax, taking in deep breaths through your nose, allowing your belly to fill up large like a hot air balloon. Then breathe out, allowing your belly to deflate.

As you go deeper and feel more and more comfortable, feel how easy it is to be relaxed and calm. Know that you deserve this calm. Breathing deep, in and out.

Now I want you to imagine an enjoyable day walking in the woods. You can hear the soft chime of birds, a light breeze brushing against your skin.

As you relax deeper and deeper, perhaps you will find a spot in the woods to sit and enjoy your surroundings. Smell the scent of pine as your breath deeper and deeper.

It feels wonderful to relax, and you allow yourself to feel this sensation deeply.”

What you say will depend on the goal of the session, and the reasoning behind the desire for hypnosis. A person may be lacking self-confidence, so you would include that within the visualization. They may be having a hard

time finding time to relax in their busy lives and may feel guilty about wanting to participate in self-care.

This will once again, be included within your description of the environment of relaxation that this subject has chosen.

Ending a Hypnosis Session: Bringing Your Subject out of Trance

This is when you bring your subject back to their usual waking state. You can tell your subject to bring themselves back, as you count down or up from 3. You tell them that they will feel relaxed and rejuvenated once they open their eyes again. Make sure that you have canceled out any hypnotic suggestions that the person does not want in their waking life. Let the person know that it is okay to come out of their trance and to begin moving their body once they have returned to the conscious state of being.

There are also other ways that you can induce someone into a trance in about 60 seconds. If you want to become a professional hypnotist, it is best to practice these short sessions as often as possible. Ten steps will fly by when practiced often:

1. **Start with H+:** This is the part where you set your intention to do your best for the person that you will hypnotize. Move into your positive energies and get excited about what is to come. Then, ask the subject for permission if they have permission to touch them on the shoulder during the induction.
2. **Induce the Trance:** Say “close your eyes and go into hypnosis.” This is an instruction that quickly links together the closing of the eyes with the state of a trance.

3. **Deepen the Trance:** Tell the person that every time you touch their shoulder, they will go deeper into a trance.
4. **Sounds around You:** Tell the person that anything they hear around them will help them go further into hypnosis.
5. **My Voice:** Tell them that your voice will follow them wherever they go, and that will allow them to hear your voice and the meaning in your words.
6. **Sanctuary:** Tell the person to feel what they are sitting on and to feel reassured that they are safe.
7. **Change Work:** This is where you add your suggestions to help the subject make the change that they want to make in their lives.
8. **Re-Induction:** You tell the person that since they are under hypnosis, that the next time they go under a trance, it will be easier for them.
9. **Self-Esteem:** Tell them something that will boost their self-esteem. Tell them that they are loved, that they make other people's lives wonderful. Let them know what a great subject they are as well, and because of this, they will make some positive changes in their life.
10. **Re-Emerge:** Bring them out of their trance by count up to 5, telling them that they will feel refreshed, relaxed, and wonderful about their lives, once they open their eyes.

These are all suggestions on how you can begin using hypnosis to positively affect the lives of those around you. If you want to learn more, perhaps you can find someone in your life or community who will hypnotize you, so you can learn how it feels and thus makes it easier for you to empathize with your subject.

Other forms of hypnosis are not recommended to engage in. For example, there is a therapeutic tool that utilizes hypnosis for those who have been greatly psychologically tormented. This is called hypnotic regression and is usually done by licensed and experienced psychologists and psychiatrists. The process is very similar to what was previously listed but much more intricate and requires a steady balance of experience and proper understanding of the process. You must not engage in this with a person of whom you may think has experienced some trauma in their life, as the incorrect usage of the technique may further traumatize them.

Brainwashing

This section offers you a few innocent tips on you can use brainwashing to improve certain aspects of your life.

This book does not condone the extensive malevolence of other brainwashing techniques, but as stated, there are ways that we can take the good out of something mainly perceived as bad. Try some of these at work, with your family, or when you meet new people, and take note of how they react!

Repeat your opinion. The usefulness of repetition has already been said a few times within this book; therefore, you are more than likely going to remember it! If you follow politics, shop online or in malls, you will easily see how useful this tactic is. People may have even heard something incorrect or even told by a person who is not trustworthy, but because so many people have heard it so many times, people are more than likely to hear it. So, if you have an opinion about something, or even want to invent a rumor (that is mainly innocent) to test out this theory, give it a go.

Imitating people makes them give you things. If you work in a service industry where tips give you most of your income, this may be a helpful tactic for you. This is something that many politicians and con artists know; by reflecting someone's words and behavior, they are more likely to follow you, and thus, reward you. This works because a person feels that you are similar to them, and if you are similar to them, then they feel obligated to somehow help you. In the service industry, this means giving more tips! If you need any research evidence, refer yourself to the Dutch study that had servers repeat half of what their customers said to them, while other servers just spoke the way they normally do while serving. The tips from the people who were mimicked were 68% more generous than those who were not mimicked. Just hearing their own words repeated back to them gave them a sense of rapport, made them feel comfortable and relatable, so they choose to give their server more money.

Saying "I'm excited" reduces stress. Saying this can help you change your perspective of fear to one of optimism, which in turn, will make you perform better at the task at hand. It tricks your brain into thinking that the reason for the anxiety turning in your stomach is about the excitement to take on a challenge, rather than fear of not doing it right.

You can try it on yourself, the next time you are really afraid to do something, such as an exam, go on a date, or present something in front of your work colleagues, try telling yourself that you are excited about it. Say it into a mirror a few times and see how your perspective on the former issue shifts.

Add a reason for your request. A research study was conducted that observed a man standing in line for coffee, who wants to cut in line in front of someone. The first time, he does it without giving a reason; he simply asks if he can cut in front of you. The second time, he provides a reason, albeit a useless and obvious reason, like that he needs to get a coffee. When most people hear this description, they reply that they would not allow the man to cut in front of them because his reasoning is not good enough. But the study found that 93% of people allowed the second person to cut in front of them simply because he provided a reason for doing so.

This works for various reasons. During our day to day lives, our resistance is very low. When we travel to work, to the gym, to a friend's house, if we have been there many times, our bodies are more than likely on automatic mode. This leaves us wide open for manipulation. Our reasoning is simplified because we don't have time to process what someone is saying or trying to do. A reason for doing something does not have to be very complex for us to allow it to happen. If it is a small favor, such as allowing someone to cut in line in front of us, or moving from a seat on the bus, we are quick to comply. Our autopilot brain might wake up a little if the request is more complicated, but if the reason is plausible, we are likely to grant it anyway.

As Alfred Adler stated, there is generally a reason behind every action that a person commits, whether or not they state it. They are obvious to most people, but if you provide a reason for needing to do something or to request a favor from them, they seem to reply with more ease and comfort. Try this out when needing things from others or placing it into your daily

vocabulary; you will find that many people will begin doing what you want quite easily.

Subliminal Messaging

You can easily apply the various techniques of subliminal messaging to help you improve your life or the life of those around you. The point of doing this is to reach into your subconscious mind and bypass the many ways your conscious mind blocks you from improving yourself. This is done by shifting your old conditioning, such as limiting beliefs and continuous behaviors that have been detrimental to your life. Here are some ways that you can integrate subliminal messages into your life:

1. **Play subliminal messages during sleep.** You can use the 6-8 hours that you sleep as a method of developing within a certain aspect of your life. Perhaps you want more self-confidence to become more dedicated to your work to be kinder to those around you. There are various themes of subliminal messages that you can listen to, and any of them are easily available on the Internet.
2. **Watch subliminal flashes on your computer screen.** You can do this for only a few minutes a day. These flashes can contain positive affirmations. This will help create a new and more positive neural pathway because of the repetition of the idea of going across your mind.
3. **Play subliminal messages during the day.** It is usually recommended that you listen to subliminal messages at night when your mind is most receptive, but you can still try to absorb these ideas during the day when you are awake. You can play subliminal

mediations in the background while you do other things, such as cook, clean, or sit and relax. Your subconscious mind can still absorb these ideas while your conscious mind is focusing on something else entirely.

4. **Place subliminal notes around you.** You can place different notes around your house, and at some point, your conscious mind will help you get used to them being around. At this point, your unconscious mind will absorb them, and thus exposure you more often to their content.

The key to allowing subliminal messages to help you become successful is by constantly exposing yourself to them. This is not something that is going to take a couple of nighttime sessions; your brain needs time to build a new pathway, a new way of thinking, and to abandon the old ways. Here is an example of successful use of subliminal notes, told by Bob Proctor, a Law of Attraction teacher:

“Focus on what you want and not what you don’t want. I wrote on a card that I was going to have \$25,000 in my possession by 1970. I wrote that on the card in 1961. I gave myself almost a decade to do it. Early on, I didn’t believe that would happen. But I’ll tell you what I learned—that if you write a lie on a card, and you read it often enough, you start to believe it. Reading that card got me thinking of earning money. Before that, I was only thinking of debts. Write what you want in the present tense, and then keep on reading. It is the repetition that fixates the idea into the subconscious mind. That’s what a paradigm is.”

Here are some suggestions about what you can do to maximize the effects of subliminal messages in your life:

1. **Set a goal.** Before starting to practice with subliminal messages, you need to know exactly what it is that you want to change. Retake some time to write this out in a notebook. There are no rules about how you write about it, but keep it clear and specific.
2. **Focus on that goal only.** Focus on that single goal, as opposed to going back and forth between a couple of different ones once you get bored. Only listen to the messages that are going to aid you in achieving one specific goal at a time.
3. **Repeat.** Try to listen to subliminal messages every day, between 4 weeks to 90 days. If you notice a change after 4 weeks, try to listen when needed. Some people need longer, and there is nothing wrong with that.
4. **Leave stress out.** Try to enjoy the process rather than rushing. Try to avoid falling into the loop of stress if you don't notice anything specific changes immediately. It is going to happen eventually, but it takes some time.

Mind Control Techniques Implemented by NLP

NLP stands for Neurolinguistic Programming and is an approach to communication, personal development, and psychotherapy that was created in the 1970s by Richard Bandler and John Grinder. The concept of NLP believes that there is a connection between neurological processes, language, and behavioral patterns learned through experience. They believed that these aspects of living as a human can be changed to achieve

specific goals in life. This approach offers many examples of mind control techniques that will be listed here for your consumption and understanding. These are used by NLP skilled professionals to try to control others mind:

1. **Paying close attention.** The professionals pay close attention to the cues of a person. This includes their body language, movement of their eyes, nervous tics, breathing patterns, etc. All of these can infer the state of mind of the individual and help make an instant emotional association between them. The NLP refers often to the movement of eyes and what it indicates to others about them, as well as the processes going on inside their mind as they answer certain questions. This is something that you would need to study specifically on your own time, as it can easily become confusing and very complex.
2. **Speaking with a suggestive frequency of the human mind.** This involves delivering words close to the beats of the human heart, which is 45 to 72 beats a minute. This could induce a higher state of suggestibility to the mind.
3. **Bypassing the conscious mind by voice roll.** This is a patterned paced style that enhances the desired point of the conversation by bypassing the conscious mind to the subconscious mind of the person. This is done by emphasizing a certain word in a monotonous patterned style.
4. **Secretly building rapport easily.** Skilled professionals use certain language to enhance suggestibility. The rapport will be created by closely examining you, and then mimicking your body language, so you are more vulnerable to suggestibility.
5. **Creating an anchor.** This is the process of creating an anchor in you, to the point where it is easy to access your suggestibility by simply

touching or tapping you

6. **A simple interpersonal subconscious programming.** This is done by seeming to dictate one thing while planting the idea of something else at the same time.

If you want to begin practicing some of these mind control techniques on others and yourself, you are going to have to learn how to focus more and thus improve control over your mind. There are various ways that you can do this, but the most important and potent is going to be mediation. You can easily practice this daily for about 20 minutes.

Meditation Practice

1. Find a place that is comfortable and quiet for you. Make sure that you will not be interrupted. You may want to put on relaxing music, or even rain sounds or sound of nature. The easiest way to do this is to open up your window and listen to the sounds right outside your window.
2. You can do this either lying down on a bed, or the floor, or by sitting in a chair. The entire point of this though is not to fall asleep, so try to choose a time of day when you are not likely to doze off.
3. Once you are comfortable, focus on your breathing. Just observe it without judgment or criticism. Observe how your stomach rises and falls as you keep breathing, in and out.
4. After a few minutes, start breathing deeper through your nose, and then out your mouth. Try to keep your attention focused on doing this, observing how your stomach inflates and deflates breath the breath going in and out.

5. You are going to have thoughts, concerns, and even doubts about the point of this practice as you go through your daily 20 minutes. When these thoughts arise, do not reject them or judge yourself. Try to recognize that you are only human, and you are going to have thoughts. Accept them as they are and let them go. This is done by not pursuing the thought further and returning your attention to your breath.
6. After 20 minutes, slowly bring your attention back to the room, returning your breath to normal breathing patterns. Open your eyes when you are ready, slowly returning to the ongoing of your day.

This practice is meant to help you notice what is going on in your mind and body, so you can take note of anything that gets in your way when you are practicing these various mind control techniques. If you do this once a day, you will begin to notice how you think about yourself, the world around you, and how calming it can be just to focus on your breath. If you are calm, then it is easier to focus on. When you focus, it will be easier to implement any of these techniques suggested in this chapter.



Chapter 9: Using Mind Control to Your Advantage

The goal of this book was to show you what the study of dark psychology is, discuss the individuals who mainly fall into the dark personality category, and to demystify the various mind control techniques that these individuals employ. There are reasons why psychopaths, Machiavellian, narcissists, and sadists tend to thrive in their lives, and that is because they possess the odd advantage of being able to participate in malevolent mind control techniques without consideration of another's wellbeing. If you are reading this, then you are probably not one of these people. Their abilities are deeply ingrained without their complex personality types and have thus shown the world the various ways of benefiting oneself in a less than honest manner.

But like any skill, the goal and reasoning behind its commitment of action can easily be skewed and altered with a much less negative intention. Mind control, influence, manipulation, persuasion, and coercion, by definition, are immoral due to the nature of deception. But deception is not entirely bad; it can be done with positive goals and intentions, and we even do it to ourselves to help us achieve a goal in our lives. If we want to lose weight, we may hide a candy bar somewhere we know we will not recall, or if we want to stop spending money, we may ask a friend to hide cash somewhere in your apartment that you will not be able to locate. Parents manipulate their children into eating healthy food, and partners keep information about an ex to save the emotions of those they love. Deception, along with its various forms of techniques applied with it, can be used for good.

We hope that you are now informed about how mind control works and that you cannot climb into another person's mind and flick a switch about them wanting to promote you. However, you can apply some of these techniques to persuade them into promoting you, highlighting why you are the best candidate for the job. We hope that you can take these skills into the world and make some lemonade from the dark lemons that darker personalities have offered us.

A book titled *The Wisdom of Psychopathy* discusses the many benefits and lessons that we as non-psychopaths can take into the daily life that would benefit us. This does not mean that you stop caring for others or applying your empathy toward those you care about but considering certain aspects of that personality type in moderation can help us lead to life success. That is the essential point of this book: to inform, educate, and offer you ways that you can put these lessons into action.

Here is a list of six lessons that psychopaths can teach you about living a fulfilling and happy life:

1. **Focus on the positive.** Many psychopaths can look at situations positively due to their lack of fear and anxiety. Anything that happens to them feels interesting, challenging, and an opportunity for growth. Try to do this the next time something seemingly negative happens to you in your life. This does not mean, of course, that you don't acknowledge what happens. It just means that you look at it from a different perspective as well. For example, if your cat pees on the floor, that is naturally annoying; but if you look at it from a positive light, perhaps you can see that it is a challenge for you to learn to train

your cat more or better, or it may be an indicator of illness. Once you can apply this mindset consistently, you will start to see initially perceived negative events as new opportunities.

2. **Stick to your beliefs.** Psychopaths are not influenced by the opinions or should be forced upon them by those around them. They are not bothered by other's beliefs or desire to change their beliefs. If you possess a belief that is important to you, do not let others try to influence you to change it. This, of course, concerns innocent and non-harmful beliefs, such as ones of human rights, animal rights, etc. If something is close to your heart and soul, don't let someone try to alter that because they are forcing themselves onto you.
3. **Don't take things personally.** It is fairly easy for people who do not have psychopathic traits to take things that people say or do fairly personally. What this essentially means is that we easily get offended when someone is always late to pick us up or if they say something about us that were not intended to hurt our feelings. Psychopaths don't be afraid or anxiety nor do they worry about what other people think, so it is fairly easy for them not to take what others say and do personally. Many relationships are disrupted or bothered by behaviors of others that are easily misinterpreted. Psychopaths take everything at face value and do not interpret anything beyond what it is. This also means that they do not get upset about career setbacks, being dumped by their partner, or anything that most people would make about themselves—something they inherently lack. Try to look at the circumstance more than yourself and realize that most things that people do have more to do with them than you.
4. **Don't overanalyze or criticize yourself.** Learning to be self-compassionate is one of the biggest keys to happiness and success.

There is nothing wrong with some constructive feedback, but because most humans are wired with a negative bias, they will think about what went wrong more so than what went right. But, if you practice self-compassion and choose to consciously look at the positive, a.k.a. what did go right, then you will build new neural pathways in your brain, making the positive thinking feel more automatic.

5. **Be fearless/Just do it.** The only way to truly overcome fears is to face them. Procrastination only adds to the frustration of not being productive. Psychopaths generally don't feel fear or anxiety, so it is easier for them to face things that will help them advance. So, try to adopt this frame of thinking, in your case, that feels the fear and does it anyway. Fear is a temporary emotion that is necessary to help us grow, and each time we face our fears, we build confidence with more willingness to face each fear as they come up in our lives. We will only get closer and closer to our dreams once we make this a habit.
6. **Stay in the present.** Psychopaths rarely waste time worrying about the future and ruminating about the past. They stay in the present moment, and by doing this, they can get the best out of it. What this means essentially is that they can focus and get tasks done, rather than falling into unhealthy thinking patterns that tend to set us back. Each moment can only be taken for what it is rather than what we think it should be. Psychopaths know this inherently, and you can too. Practicing mindfulness will help you do this, and you do that by meditating and applying other exercises that were previously described in this book. Mindful eating, walking, even showering, or brushing your teeth can help you be in that moment, rather than deep in your mind. Once this has become a habit in your life, it will be easier to see things as they are, not categorizing them as positive or

negative, but with deep acceptance. Acceptance will help you when life becomes more challenging, rather than ruminating and worrying about potentially negative results.

Go through this book and this list and begin to utilize the skills that dominate the Dark Triad. You will learn that using these to your advantage will help you to lead a happier, more fulfilling, anxiety-free life.



[1] <https://www.ipredator.co/dark-psychology/>

[2] Hotchkiss, Sandy & [Masterson, James F.](#) Why Is It Always About You? : The Seven Deadly Sins of Narcissism (2003)

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